

WELCOME TO THE
INDOVERSE

INDOVERSE

VOLUME 2

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SANJIVANI
ARC

Chapter 1: Break of Expectations

The blue glow of the screen reflected across Om's face. The rest of the room was dark—the curtains were drawn, the ceiling fan spun lazily overhead, and the sound of an online coaching class echoed through his earphones. It was the final Chemistry lecture. The teacher kept writing equations on the screen, but one of Om's eyes remained fixed on another browser tab where the CBSE results website kept displaying the same message:

Error 503.

The class finally ended. He took off his earphones.

An uneasy silence settled over the room.

Om pressed **F5** once again.

"The website still isn't loading," he muttered to himself, as if saying it aloud could somehow make time move faster.

Just then, his phone lit up.

Dad was calling.

"Hello, Dad?"

"They're showing on the news that the results are out. Yours must be out too. Check quickly."

With one hand still holding the phone, Om refreshed the page again.

This time, the website opened.

He entered his roll number.

Then his date of birth.

He took a deep breath.

80.4%.

For a moment, he simply stared at the screen.

His heart didn't sink.

Neither did fireworks go off inside him.

It was... fine.

The kind of happiness you feel when reality lands somewhere close to what you expected.

"Dad... I got eighty percent."

"Good. That's fine."

That was all.

The call ended.

Om kept holding the phone for a few more seconds.

Maybe Dad's still at the office, he thought.

Maybe that's why he couldn't say much.

Maybe he'll bring sweets home in the evening.

Maybe.

When he told his mother, she immediately put her phone to her ear.

"Yes, Didi! Om scored **eighty-two percent**... Yes, yes, very good marks... I kept telling you, this boy works really hard..."

Om stood there silently.

Eighty-two.

He had clearly said eighty.

But the pride in his mother's voice wasn't meant for him.

It was meant for the people listening.

Quietly, he returned to his room.

At nine that night, his father came home.

There was no box of sweets in his hands.

Only the usual exhaustion on his face.

Om was sitting on the sofa.

He looked up.

"Listen, son. You know your percentage is eighty. Other schools ask for eighty-five percent if you want Science. If you change schools, there'll be a new environment, new expenses... who knows how it'll go? Stay in this school. It'll be easier to adjust."

Om stayed silent for a moment.

Something stirred inside him.

Not anger.

Not sadness.

Just... a quiet ache.

"Okay, Dad. I'll stay here."

"Good."

And that was it.

No *"You can do it."*

No *"We're with you."*

It was treated like a logistical problem—

not an emotional moment.

Back in his room, Om closed the door behind him.

He looked at his empty palm.

No sweets had ever come.

I wanted to be happy.

Was that really so difficult?

The days passed.

One after another.

Like products rolling off an assembly line.

Wake up.

Go to school.

Come back.

Coaching.

Dinner.

Study.

Sleep.

Again.

And again.

Every single day.

Whenever he wanted to go outside, his mother stopped him.

"The neighborhood isn't good. Why do you need to go?"

If he wanted to hang out with friends—

"First settle your studies. Everything else can wait."

Whenever he talked about visiting somewhere new—

"Focus on your studies for now."

One day, Om asked his mother,

"Mom... if someone gets into a car accident, do they stop sitting in cars forever?"

She looked at him for a second.

Then changed the subject.

Om understood.

He wasn't going to get an answer.

There's a difference between care and overprotection.

One supports you.

The other holds you back.

But how do I explain that to them?

Then came **that night**.

There was no special reason.

No major argument.

No terrible news.

It was just another ordinary night—

the same ordinary life that had slowly begun hollowing him out from within.

Om lay on his bed, staring at the ceiling where the fan kept spinning with the same tired rhythm—

never stopping,

never changing,

simply spinning.

Just like me, Om thought.

He, too, kept moving in circles.

School.

Coaching.

Home.

School.

Coaching.

Home.

Round after round.

No destination.

No finish line.

Just a fixed circle that he entered every morning and escaped only when he fell asleep at night.

Is this life?

Is this all it's ever going to be?

He was tired.

But not the kind of tiredness that sleep could fix.

This was the exhaustion inside him—

the kind that comes when someone keeps trying...

and nothing ever changes.

I'm useless, he thought.

No...

I'm not useless.

I just... exist.

I'm here.

That's all.

And somehow,

that night,

those two words—

that's all—

felt unbearably heavy.

"Om! Dinner's ready! Come!"

His mother's voice broke the silence.

Om took a deep breath, got up, opened the door, and walked outside.

What else could he do?

The television was on while everyone ate.

Absent-mindedly, Om tore a piece of roti.

Then suddenly, the news anchor's voice grew louder.

On the screen, the sky above **San Francisco** had turned crimson and black.

A colossal alien ship hovered overhead.

A bright red **BREAKING NEWS** banner flashed across the screen.

The whole world seemed to be holding its breath.

Om looked up.

The broadcast shifted to a stage filled with thousands of people.

An anchor stepped forward with a microphone.

"Ladies and gentlemen...

Please welcome—

Ishaan Kumar Singh...

the man who saved us from the threat of humanity's extinction!"

The crowd erupted.

Then Ishaan walked onto the stage.

The same tired face.

The same simplicity.

He took the microphone.

Paused for a moment.

The entire world fell silent.

"I was once trapped inside a room too.

I had no freedom to step outside...

no freedom to speak...

no freedom to truly live.

But I learned one thing.

Freedom is never given.

It is earned.

And freedom has only one currency—

success."

Om's hand froze.

The piece of bread remained half torn.

The ceiling fan was still spinning.

The circle of his life was still there.

But that one sentence—

it broke something.

Or perhaps...

it put something back together.

Inside him.

Freedom has only one currency—success.

Om quietly pushed his plate aside.

He walked back to his room.

Closed the door.

And for the first time in months,

when he looked up at the ceiling fan,

his face carried a different expression.

Not exhaustion.

A decision.

No more wasting time.

Not anymore.

First... I have to become successful.

Chapter 2: First Priority

After that night, Om was no longer the same.

Ishaan's words—

"Freedom has only one currency—success."

—were no longer just a quote.

They had become something engraved into the walls of Om's mind.

He woke up hearing those words.

He went to sleep thinking about them.

Whether he was sitting in school listening to lectures or solving equations during coaching—
the same voice echoed inside him.

I have to succeed.

I have to succeed.

I have to succeed.

He began preparing for **NEET**.

Properly.

Seriously.

Openly.

He told his family.

He told his coaching teachers.

There was no dramatic announcement.

No grand speech.

Just a decision that had already been made.

Every night, after everyone in the house had gone to sleep, Om studied for hours.

NEET guides.

Biology diagrams.

Physics problems.

Everything together.

Ishaan had become his idol.

He read everything he could find about him.

His interviews.

His journey.

The story behind **SAHAY**.

Everything.

And the more he learned, the more convinced he became.

If an invisible boy could achieve all that...

Why can't I?

I will do it too.

I have to.

School was a different world altogether.

To everyone else, Om was just the quiet boy who sat near the back of the classroom and rarely made much noise.

But to the people who truly knew him—

he was someone else entirely.

Their group had five people.

Om.

Gauri.

Rupkatha—a Bengali girl who had moved from Kolkata two years earlier. Every now and then Bengali words slipped into her Hindi, making everyone laugh.

Mihir—from Madhya Pradesh, straightforward and honest to the core.

And Tanish—

the weakest student in class when it came to marks,

but the funniest person in the canteen.

The entire class knew Rupkatha and Mihir liked each other.

Only the two of them refused to admit it.

Whenever someone caught them together, Mihir's face turned bright red while Rupkatha suddenly became very interested in fixing her hair.

Tanish struggled with studies.

But Om never left him behind.

Every lunch break, he sat beside Tanish and explained Physics—

again...

and again...

using different methods,

never getting tired.

One day Tanish finally asked,

"Why do you help me so much?"

Om shrugged.

"Because you can do it.

You just don't know it yet."

Tanish looked at him for a moment before lowering his eyes toward his notebook.

He didn't say much.

But from that day onward,

he paid a little more attention in class.

And then there was...

Gauri.

Om didn't have words for what he felt about her.

Whatever it was...

it simply refused to become language.

Whenever she spoke,

his attention drifted away from the lecture.

Whenever she laughed,

it felt as though the room became brighter.

Whenever she frowned slightly while thinking seriously about something,

his heart skipped a beat.

But he never said anything.

Neither did Gauri.

Both of them knew.

Both of them pretended they didn't.

Because sometimes,

the fear of losing a friendship weighs far more than love itself.

Then one day, Gauri made an announcement to the group.

"I scored ninety percent in my boards.

And...

I got admission into Science City School."

Silence.

"GAURI!"

Rupkatha screamed as she hugged her.

Mihir clapped enthusiastically.

Tanish dramatically pretended to faint.

"So my topper friend is leaving while I'm still failing? Traitor!"

Everyone burst into laughter.

Om laughed too.

A genuine laugh.

Because Gauri's happiness was real,

and seeing her happy genuinely made him happy.

But somewhere inside,

something hurt.

That school was on the other side of the city.

Which meant—

no more meeting every day.

No more lunch breaks together.

No more random conversations—

sometimes about Physics,

sometimes about movies,

sometimes about absolutely nothing.

She's leaving, Om thought.

And I'll stay here.

Just like always.

Tanish came up with an idea.

"Guys, let's have one last meetup before Gauri leaves.

Let's all go to the mall."

Everyone looked at one another.

Then nodded together.

Permission from home was the only obstacle.

Rupkatha got permission.

Mihir got permission.

Tanish didn't even need to ask.

Things weren't that strict at his house.

Gauri got permission too.

Then came Om's turn.

After dinner, when everyone seemed relaxed, Om carefully brought up the topic.

"Mom...

Can I ask you something?"

"Yes?"

"Our group wants to go to the mall once before Gauri changes schools...

Just one last meetup."

"Who's going?" his father asked without taking his eyes off the television.

"The five of us...

Me, Gauri, Rupkatha, Mihir, and Tanish."

"There are girls too?"

his mother asked, raising an eyebrow.

"Yeah... Gauri and Rupkatha are coming, but they're just friends, it's not—"

"No."

His father answered simply.

"The world isn't safe these days.

Even friends betray people now.

We're not modern like that.

Understand?"

"But Dad, it's just this one—"

"I already said no."

Om looked at his parents for a moment.

There was no anger on their faces.

No harsh expressions.

Just a final decision.

One that left no room for discussion.

Quietly,

he returned to his room.

He opened the **SUS** group chat.

"Guys... I can't come. Dad said no."

Replies flooded in almost instantly.

Tanish: *Bro* 🥺🥺

Rupkatha: *Om nooo* 🥺

Mihir: *Any chance you can convince them?*

Gauri: *...It's okay. We'll miss you.* 😞

Om put the phone down.

The screen went dark.

He sat beside the window.

Outside, the evening sunlight was slowly fading.

He imagined them sitting together in a food court.

Tanish stuffing an oversized burger into his mouth.

Rupkatha and Mihir somehow ending up sitting next to each other again.

Gauri...

perhaps glancing toward the entrance every now and then.

Photos started appearing in the group chat.

Everyone smiling.

Everyone together.

Ice cream.

Selfies.

One deliberately serious photo—

probably forced by Tanish.

Om looked at every single picture.

Then he locked his phone.

Don't cry.

Don't let anyone feel guilty.

He stayed silent.

Deep inside,

something remained buried.

But there was simply no place for it to come out.

The next day, the school held a drill.

Everyone was asked to stand in a line.

A teacher announced,

"Today we'll do a simple activity.

Each student will choose their best friend and go stand beside them."

The classroom exploded with movement.

People ran across the room.

Laughter.

Shouting.

"Come here!"

"No, you're my partner!"

Om stayed where he was.

He watched Mihir rush toward Rupkatha.

She rolled her eyes—

but smiled anyway.

Tanish grabbed another friend's hand and disappeared into the crowd.

Finally, the teacher looked at Om.

"Om...

Choose your best friend."

Om thought for a moment.

Then smiled softly.

"Ma'am...

How can I choose just one?

I have lots of friends."

The teacher smiled.

A few students laughed.

Om turned around.

There was no one standing behind him.

Everyone had chosen someone.

Everyone belonged to someone.

Om was friends with everyone.

Which meant...

he truly belonged to no one.

He wasn't anyone's **first priority**.

The drill ended.

Om returned to his seat.

He opened his notebook.

But he didn't write a single word.

That evening, he spread out his Chemistry, Physics, and Biology notes.

Pages turned.

Equations blurred together.

He thought about buying a tablet.

Digital notes would be far more organized.

It would help with NEET too.

His father was standing outside the room.

Om walked toward him.

But the moment he looked at his father's tired eyes...

his exhausted hands after another long day at work...

something caught in Om's throat.

I couldn't even satisfy him with eighty percent.

And now I'm going to ask for such an expensive gift?

"Did you need something?"

his father asked.

Om forced a smile.

"No, Dad.

Nothing."

He returned to his room.

Closed the door.

Picked up his notes.

Then put them back down.

He stared at the ceiling.

The fan kept spinning.

The same old circle.

The same endless motion.

But this time...

Om didn't look at it with exhaustion.

He noticed something else.

The fan never stopped.

No matter what happened,

it simply kept turning.

Maybe that's what I have to do.

Just keep moving.

Never stop.

He picked up his **NEET guide**.

Opened the very first page.

That day's drill had taught him something.

He wasn't anyone's first priority.

So now,

there was only one path left.

To become so successful...

that the world would have no choice but to make him its first priority.

Chapter 3: Do We Really Need Freedom?

After that day, Om changed.

But it wasn't the kind of change people could see. His face didn't become harder. His voice didn't become heavier. It was a change that happened deep inside him—quietly, slowly. Like an old wall that looked perfectly fine from the outside but had already turned hollow within.

Om started working smarter.

There was an old podcast by Ishaan that had engraved itself into Om's mind.

"People think success comes only from hard work. That's the biggest misunderstanding. There is no substitute for hard work—but hard work alone only gives you exhaustion. Success comes from smart work. Doing the right thing, at the right time, in the right way."

Om listened to that podcast three times.

Then he completely changed the way he studied.

First, he analyzed everything.

Which topics had appeared the most in NEET over the last ten years?

Which chapters carried the highest weightage?

Which questions followed predictable patterns?

He drew an entire pattern map by hand in an old notebook and built his study schedule around it.

Only what mattered.

Only what would actually help.

Everything else could wait.

And every night, after everyone in the house had fallen asleep...

Om worked on something else.

The blueprint of a biological device.

Time never waits.

That was the first lesson Om truly learned during those months.

Days passed one after another, and with each passing day, NEET came closer.

Teachers at coaching became more serious.

Even Tanish had started studying harder—perhaps because of Om, or perhaps because of himself.

Either way, he had changed.

Gauri was now studying in another school.

Sometimes a message appeared in the SUS group chat—a meme, a random joke—but the warmth that once existed wasn't there anymore.

Distance isn't measured only in kilometers.

Om pushed every distraction aside.

Success first. Everything else later.

The day of NEET finally arrived.

Om woke up with a strange heaviness in his stomach.

His hands trembled slightly.

He washed his face, somehow finished a few bites of breakfast, picked up his admit card, and stood at the door.

His father looked at him once.

"Ready?"

"Yes, Papa."

"Do your best."

That was all.

But that day...

Om didn't need anything more.

As he entered the examination hall, he stopped for a brief moment.

Around him stood hundreds of students.

Nervous faces.

Shaking hands.

Eyes filled with fear.

Yet strangely...

Om felt calm.

This is the biggest key to my freedom.

Today... I have to unlock that door.

He opened the question paper.

Read the first question.

Took one deep breath.

And began writing.

Three hours later...

When Om walked out of the examination hall, he didn't look back even once.

There was no reason to.

He had already done everything he could.

His phone buzzed.

Tanish: *How did it go, bro??*

Om smiled faintly.

Om: *Selection confirmed.*

Tanish: *Bro, look at this confidence* 🤔🔥

Om locked his phone and quietly started walking home.

For the first time in a long while, there was a different rhythm in his footsteps.

Neither hurried.

Nor hesitant.

Simply... steady.

A few days later...

Om was sitting in his room when the news broke.

One headline.

Then another.

Then dozens more.

Every single one carried the same message.

"NEET 2026 Paper Leaked. NTA Announces Re-Examination."

Om stared at the screen.

Once.

Twice.

Again.

Then he quietly placed the phone beside him.

The ceiling fan kept spinning.

Birds continued chirping outside.

Everything looked perfectly normal...

As if the world had no idea that the ground beneath someone's feet had just disappeared.

Re-examination.

All those months.

The analysis.

The smart work.

Those three hours.

Everything became meaningless in a single moment.

He was being punished...

For someone else's mistake.

Om walked straight to his father.

He didn't know what to say.

He just wanted to stand there.

His father looked into his eyes and understood everything.

Without saying much, he placed a hand on Om's shoulder.

"Come."

"Let's go to the temple today."

"It'll help clear your mind."

Om simply nodded.

The temple was crowded.

The sound of bells echoed through the air.

Incense filled the surroundings.

Hundreds of people stood there carrying their own pain...

And their own prayers.

Om folded his hands.

Closed his eyes.

From the outside...

He looked exactly like everyone else.

But inside...

He was fighting.

Why?

Why me?

What did I do wrong?

I worked hard.

I worked smart.

I did everything right.

Then why?

If You truly exist... then why?

No answer came.

The bells continued ringing.

The incense kept burning.

The crowd kept moving.

Om opened his eyes.

And walked out.

He was almost home...

When something felt wrong.

At first he thought it was an illusion.

Then he stopped.

Then he walked faster.

Then...

He ran.

His apartment building...

Was gone.

Only rubble remained.

Concrete.

Steel rods.

Broken walls.

Dust.

People stood around in silence.

Some cried.

Some spoke on their phones.

Some simply stared.

Om grabbed someone's arm.

"What happened?"

"How...?"

The man replied with a trembling voice.

"A red crack appeared in the sky..."

"A giant rock fell straight onto the building."

"It collapsed completely."

"The people who were inside..."

Om didn't hear the rest.

His legs refused to move.

He stared at the ruins.

Papa had been there.

Mom had been there.

They were the ones who had told him to visit the temple.

That's why...

He was alive.

And that's why...

He was alone.

The next few hours became a blur.

Who arrived.

Who left.

Who spoke.

What anyone said.

He remembered none of it.

He remembered only one thing.

A woman had told him that this wasn't happening only here.

It was happening across the world.

The same crimson portals.

The same falling rocks.

The same destruction.

Om sat alone in a deserted corner.

He had nothing left.

No home.

No mother.

No father.

Something inside him had shattered.

Yet no tears came.

No screams.

Only an emptiness so deep...

It felt bottomless.

What now?

Just then...

A notification appeared on his phone.

A news alert.

He opened it.

For the first time that night...

Something returned to his eyes.

"IKS – Ishaan Kinetic Systems. Grand Inauguration Tomorrow. Ishaan Kumar Singh's Biggest Venture Yet."

Om stared at the screen.

Ishaan.

His idol.

The man who had taught him that freedom is earned through success.

The man who had preached smart work.

The man who had lost everything...

Yet still stood back up.

Tomorrow.

I have to go.

Maybe... maybe one last hope still exists.

The next day...

Om stood outside the massive IKS headquarters.

Thousands of people had gathered.

Media vans.

Television cameras.

Excitement filled the air.

Among them stood Om.

Wearing the same old clothes.

Eyes hollow after a sleepless night.

But he was there.

On the stage...

Ishaan appeared.

Thunderous applause erupted.

For the first time, Om saw his idol from so close.

The same tired face.

The same simplicity.

But those eyes...

They still carried a fire.

A fire Om had only seen through television screens.

Ishaan stepped toward the microphone.

His voice echoed across the entire venue.

Om listened carefully.

Every single word.

But then—

A group of uniformed officers pushed through the crowd.

Official documents in their hands.

"Ishaan Kumar Singh..."

"You are required to come with us immediately."

"You are being accused that the portals... the destruction... and these deaths are the result of your time-travel experiments."

For one brief moment...

The entire venue fell silent.

Then chaos erupted.

People shouted.

Cameras flashed.

Security rushed forward.

Om stood completely still...

Watching as Ishaan was taken away.

For a brief second...

Ishaan looked toward the crowd.

Toward Om.

And Om felt that there was something in that glance.

An apology.

A pain too deep for words.

Then...

He was gone.

Thousands of people surrounded him.

Yet Om had never felt so alone.

No home.

No parents.

And now...

Even Ishaan was gone.

His last hope...

Had disappeared.

Om turned around.

And walked away.

Without a destination.

Without a direction.

Chapter 4: Sanjivani

Night had grown deep.

Om kept walking with no direction and no destination.

The city's streets were still alive—cars, lights, people—but to Om, everything felt like a blurry film someone else was watching.

His feet kept moving.

His mind didn't.

A strange burning sensation twisted inside his stomach. He hadn't eaten anything for two days. The cold night breeze brushed against him, but he didn't even notice.

He had nothing left.

Absolutely nothing.

As he turned into a narrow alley, three or four shadows suddenly stepped in front of him.

"Hey. Stop."

Om stopped.

They looked him up and down.

"Hand over your phone."

For a moment, Om thought about it.

Then he simply took out his phone.

What else could he do?

Fight?

Against whom?

For what?

But the moment he stretched out his hand, one of them drove a hard punch into his stomach.

Om doubled over.

Another snatched the phone.

A third struck him across the head.

He collapsed onto the ground.

He lay there.

His stomach burned.

Something warm trickled down from his forehead.

It hurt.

But beyond the pain was something even heavier.

Exhaustion.

A kind so deep...

...that all he wanted to do was close his eyes.

Just stay here.

Don't get up.

He remained lying there.

Ten minutes.

Maybe longer.

He had completely lost track of time.

Then...

Headlights appeared.

A car stopped.

Two doors opened.

"Om?"

That voice.

Om slowly opened his eyes.

His vision was blurry.

But even through the haze...

He recognized that face.

After all this time...

He still recognized it.

Gauri.

And beside her...

Her father.

Gauri rushed to his side the moment she stepped out.

"Om... what happened?"

"You're bleeding—"

Her father immediately understood the situation.

He knelt beside Om and supported him.

"Son, can you stand?"

"We need to get you to a hospital."

"I'm... fine," Om whispered.

The words barely came out.

"You're absolutely not fine," Gauri said, her voice trembling though her hands remained steady.

"Papa... help me."

Together they lifted Om into the car.

The doctors cleaned and dressed his wounds.

The cut on his head was bandaged.

The pain in his stomach slowly eased.

A nurse handed him a few dry biscuits and a glass of juice.

Om stared at them.

Then he began eating.

And he couldn't stop.

Two days of hunger poured out all at once.

Gauri and her father quietly watched him.

Neither of them said a word.

When Om finally stopped...

His hands were shaking.

"You haven't eaten in two days?"

Gauri asked softly.

Om nodded.

Her father looked at her.

Neither spoke.

"Come home with us."

Gauri's voice left no room for argument.

"Right now."

The lights were on inside Gauri's house.

Her mother opened the door.

The moment she saw Om's condition...

She silently walked into the kitchen.

No questions.

No interrogation.

Nothing.

Gauri's family had known Om since school.

He wasn't a stranger.

He was a familiar boy...

Someone whom life had shattered.

Her father simply said,

"Stay here for as long as you want."

"You don't have to worry."

Om quietly sat there.

The house smelled of warm food...

Of incense...

Of something only a real home possesses.

Warmth.

Suddenly...

He remembered his own home.

His own apartment building.

He quietly closed his eyes.

Days passed.

Living in Gauri's house, Om realized something for the first time.

Life wasn't over yet.

Three proper meals every day.

A roof over his head.

The way Gauri's mother never directly asked if he was okay...

Yet somehow always placed an extra serving on his plate.

And every night...

After everyone had gone to sleep...

Om would sit with an empty notebook.

He started drawing a new blueprint.

Everything else was gone.

His house.

His mother.

His father.

But one thing had survived.

The idea.

It was still alive inside his mind.

He started again.

One line at a time.

A device capable of healing any external injury on the human body...

Within ten minutes.

Every night brought another challenge.

Every morning raised another question.

Every evening brought another answer.

Then one night...

He thought of SAHAY.

Ishaan had left SAHAY open for the entire world to use.

Om borrowed Gauri's old laptop.

"I need it for something," he had said.

He opened SAHAY's interface.

"SAHAY..."

he whispered.

"Yes, Om."

"I'm here."

The familiar, calming voice echoed through the speakers.

For a moment...

Om simply sat there.

It had been so long since someone's voice had made him feel something.

"I want to build a device."

"I'll need your help."

"Tell me."

SAHAY replied.

"I'm here."

Nine months later...

Om joined IKS.

The rest of the story is already known to the world.

The journey through **ASCENT**.

The battles.

The choices.

And when Ishaan walked away from everything...

His company.

His technology.

His legacy...

The responsibility of IKS passed into Om's hands.

Because Ishaan knew...

Om would understand.

What Om had gained after losing everything...

Very few people ever could.

Present Day

The new IKS Hospital.

Thousands of people stood outside.

Media vans.

Cameras.

Reporters.

The same excitement that had once surrounded the inauguration of IKS...

The day a broken boy had stood in the crowd searching for his final hope.

But today...

That boy stood on the stage.

Om picked up the microphone.

He looked across the sea of faces.

The cameras.

The people.

Then he began speaking.

"Today, we are inaugurating IKS Hospital."

His voice carried neither excitement nor nervousness.

Only quiet certainty.

"And today..."

"We are launching a device that was first imagined one night..."

"...inside an empty notebook."

He paused.

"Its name is..."

"Sanjivani."

The audience erupted into applause.

"This device can heal any external injury on the human body within ten minutes."

"It is more than technology."

"It is the memory of the night I decided..."

"...that I would never stop moving forward."

The crowd listened in complete silence.

Om lowered the microphone slightly.

There was something different on his face.

Not pride.

Not excitement.

Peace.

"And one more thing."

"Starting tomorrow..."

"The wedding celebrations at my home will begin."

"And on the 26th of April..."

"Gauri and I..."

"...are getting married."

For the first time during the speech...

Om smiled.

Thousands of people stood before him.

The media.

The IKS team.

Guests.

But his eyes searched for only one person.

The first row.

Where Gauri sat.

Now a software engineer.

The same girl who had once stopped her car on a lonely road...

To save a broken boy.

Gauri smiled back.

Chapter 5: The God's Gift

26th April.

Since morning, the city carried a different kind of excitement.

Luxury cars kept arriving outside the IKS headquarters one after another.

The wedding venue was decorated with flowers, lights, and the rhythmic beats of traditional drums.

People kept pouring in—family members, close friends, dignitaries, those who knew Om personally, and those who knew him only by his name.

Om stood on the stage in his sherwani.

Straight.

Calm.

But deep inside, there was a place he could never show anyone.

An empty space.

Two faces were missing from the crowd.

If they had been here, they would have been sitting in the very front.

His father would surely have made some innocent mistake during the ceremony...

...and his mother would have quietly corrected him.

But they weren't there.

Om closed his eyes for a moment.

You're watching me... aren't you?

Somewhere?

No answer came.

Yet somehow...

...he felt at peace.

As if no answer was necessary.

The exchange of garlands was over.

When Gauri had placed the garland around Om's neck, the expression that appeared on his face wasn't something he had planned.

It had simply happened.

There was something in Gauri's eyes too...

The same feeling that had existed back in school.

Only deeper now.

It was time for the sacred wedding vows.

And, just like every Indian wedding...

Chaos ruled the moment.

Someone was taking photographs.

Someone was crying.

Someone was laughing.

Some elderly uncle kept instructing everyone where to sit and when to stand.

Bhuvan and Mikhail arrived.

Their daughter was with them.

Mikhail looked at Om and smiled warmly.

Bhuvan climbed onto the stage and hugged him tightly.

"You really made it, brother."

"You actually made it."

Mikhail looked at Gauri.

Then at Om.

Then smiled.

"Good choice."

She said softly.

No one knew whether she meant Gauri...

...or life itself.

The photo session began.

Relatives.

Friends.

Colleagues.

Everyone took their turn.

Then...

Kenji arrived.

He walked slowly with the same old pace.

But his eyes remained as sharp...

...and as warm...

...as ever.

He looked at Om.

Then at Gauri.

Then quietly said,

"Anjali would've loved this."

His voice was heavy.

Just those few words.

Nothing more.

Kenji then noticed the little girl standing beside Bhuvan.

"What is her name?"

he asked.

Bhuvan smiled.

A smile carrying pride...

Pain...

And an old memory.

"Avika."

he replied.

"In Ishaan's memory."

Kenji couldn't say another word.

He simply looked at the little girl...

Who had absolutely no idea why all these grown-ups had suddenly fallen silent...

And his eyes filled with tears.

Suddenly...

A voice came from outside.

"Whose black car is that?"

Another followed.

"That's one expensive car... whose number plate is that?"

A ripple spread through the crowd.

Everyone looked toward the entrance.

The car stopped.

Its dark tinted door slowly opened.

And the moment the man stepped out...

Om's world froze.

Ishaan.

The same tired face.

The same simplicity.

The same eyes...

Still burning with determination.

But now...

There was something else in them.

Something that hadn't been there before.

The crowd instinctively moved aside.

No one told them to.

They simply knew...

This man would reach the stage.

Nothing could stop him.

Ishaan climbed onto the stage.

He looked at Om.

Om looked back.

There were no words that belonged to this moment.

Ishaan first looked at Gauri.

A small smile.

Then turned back to Om.

"OG photo."

That was all he said.

Everyone gathered together.

Ishaan.

Om.

Gauri.

Bhuvan.

Mikhail.

Kenji.

Little Avika rested in Mikhail's arms.

The photographer arranged everyone.

Different heights.

Different faces.

Different lives.

Yet...

One single frame.

The camera clicked.

For a brief moment...

Om simply absorbed the feeling of that photograph.

Avika wasn't physically there.

But her presence remained.

In Gauri's eyes.

In the little girl's name.

In Kenji's silence.

Some people never truly leave.

They simply change the way they stay.

After the photograph...

Ishaan walked toward Om.

He reached inside his jacket and took out a small box.

Simple.

Plain.

No ribbon.

"Gift."

he said.

Om accepted it.

"I'll open it later."

"No."

Ishaan replied.

"Not now."

"Later."

Om nodded.

Ishaan looked into his eyes one last time.

Then quietly said,

"This may be the last time you ever see me."

"After this..."

"Don't try to find me."

"And even if you do..."

"You won't."

Something tightened inside Om's throat.

"Ishaan..."

But Ishaan had already turned away.

Once again...

The crowd made way for him.

The black car's door opened.

Closed.

And slowly disappeared into the distance.

Om stood there silently.

The wedding music continued.

The drums still played.

People laughed.

Conversations carried on.

Life kept moving.

But for a brief moment...

Om wasn't there.

Gauri gently held his hand.

Only then...

He returned to the present.

Late that night...

After the wedding...

The gifts were finally being opened.

Om suddenly remembered Ishaan's box.

He opened it.

Inside...

Was a bracelet.

Made of plain metal.

Simple in appearance.

Yet embedded within it was a strange gemstone.

It wasn't a diamond.

Nor a sapphire.

Nor any gemstone Om had ever seen.

It was...

Something else.

It emitted a glow that was neither fully bright...

Nor completely dim.

It simply...

Existed.

Om picked it up.

It felt cold.

But the moment he wore it...

A faint warmth spread across his wrist.

Gauri noticed it.

"Whose gift is that?"

she asked.

"Ishaan's."

Om answered.

Gauri looked at the bracelet.

Then at Om.

She said nothing.

Neither did Om.

No one knew what that mysterious gem truly was.

But Om could feel one thing.

This wasn't just a piece of jewelry.

It was...

Something far greater.

What it truly was...

...would only be revealed in the chapters yet to come.



GLITCH ARC

Chapter 1: Angel's Home

Three days earlier, a message had popped up in the SUS GC.

Tanish: *"Guys, let's go to Kolkata once. Rupkatha's grandmother invited us, and we can explore the city too."*

Om looked at the message.

Then he looked outside at Delhi's grey sky.

Then back at the screen.

Om: *"Yeah. Let's go."*

It was night inside the train.

All five of them—Om, Gauri, Rupkatha, Mihir, and Tanish—were sitting in the same compartment.

Tanish pushed his oversized backpack onto the luggage rack above.

The bag contained absolutely nothing useful.

Only packets of chips...

...and an **"Emergency Blanket"** he had bought three years ago for a camping trip that never happened.

"Why did you bring the emergency blanket?" Mihir asked.

"In case it gets cold."

"It's June."

"Emergencies don't announce themselves, Mihir."

Rupkatha burst into laughter. She muttered something in Bengali before translating herself.

"You two are never going to change."

Gauri sat beside Om by the window.

Outside, darkness rushed past the train.

Occasionally tiny lights appeared—small towns, lonely farms, reflections over rivers.

"Have you ever been to Kolkata before?" Gauri asked.

"No."

"But I've heard a lot about it."

"From whom?"

"Bhuvan bhai."

"He said his home was there... in Shantinagar."

Morning.

Howrah Station.

The air was filled with mist.

The station itself felt like an entire city—thousands of people, thousands of destinations, thousands of voices.

Rupkatha immediately looked at home.

This was her city.

Mihir looked completely lost.

An MP boy experiencing Kolkata for the first time.

Meanwhile, Tanish proudly pulled out his emergency blanket.

"Bro... the train had AC."

Om grabbed the blanket and shoved it straight back into his bag.

"So... hotel?" Gauri asked.

"No need."

Om pulled out a key from his jacket.

"Bhuvan bhai gave this to me."

"He has a house here. It's empty."

"And he allowed us?" Mihir asked.

"I asked."

"He said... a home should never stay empty."

Shantinagar felt different.

Even though it stood in the middle of Kolkata...

...it somehow existed outside the city.

Old trees.

Clean roads.

A security gate.

The watchman recognized Om immediately.

"Bhuvan bhai told me you'd be coming."

The apartment building was old.

Not the kind that decays...

The kind that grows wiser.

The paint had faded in places.

But the house itself was perfectly maintained.

Om turned the key.

The door opened.

A familiar smell greeted him.

Old books.

Naphthalene balls.

And something else...

Something impossible to identify.

Yet strangely familiar.

As if he had lived here once.

Even though he never had.

"It's huge," Tanish said while walking inside.

"Bhuvan bhai had a big family."

"Everyone used to live here."

"When Ishaan bhai was still studying till Class 8."

Behind the building was a playground.

A cement cricket pitch.

Old.

Weathered.

Yet the faded white markings still survived.

One side still had an old practice net dancing gently with the wind.

Om stood there silently.

Someone had spent countless evenings here.

A boy who would later become the greatest name in the world...

...was once just another child playing cricket after school.

Everyone freshened up.

Tea was made.

Tanish somehow found another packet of chips.

"Let's visit Kalighat Temple," Rupkatha suggested.

"Absolutely!" Mihir replied.

"I'm staying."

Om shook his head.

"I'm not feeling well."

"You guys go."

Gauri looked at him carefully.

There was a question in her eyes.

Om smiled softly.

"I'm okay."

"Go."

She nodded.

But before leaving...

...she turned back one last time.

Om remained standing until every voice disappeared.

There was another key attached to the keychain.

Bhuvan bhai had mentioned it once.

"There's another room across the hallway.

If you ever decide to enter...

go alone."

Om picked up the second key.

Unlocked the opposite door.

It looked like a storage room.

Yet...

Nothing inside felt abandoned.

Everything was arranged carefully.

Almost lovingly.

Like a museum.

Or like someone was expected to return someday.

One shelf displayed dozens of cricket trophies.

District championships.

State championships.

Even a National-level certificate.

Every single one carried the same name.

Ishaan Kumar Singh.

This belonged to Kolkata.

To the days when Ishaan was simply...

Ishaan.

Not AIR-1.

Not the Cyber God.

Just a boy who loved cricket...

...and spent his nights imagining impossible things.

In one corner rested an old cricket bat.

The grip had worn away.

The wood carried scratches from years of use.

Several signatures covered its surface.

It had clearly belonged to an entire team.

Above every signature...

One line was written in bold letters.

"Never Give Up — I.K.S."

Om picked up the bat.

It felt surprisingly light.

Yet...

The moment it touched his hands...

Something felt different.

As if an old sleeping energy still lived inside it.

Stacks of papers lay nearby.

Equations.

Diagrams.

Some written in Hindi.

Some in English.

Some in a language that was neither.

These belonged to the Kolkata years.

Before SAHAY.

Before the world knew Ishaan.

When he was dreaming of something even bigger.

Om continued flipping through the papers.

One after another.

Then—

A blueprint.

Covered from both sides.

Equations.

Diagrams.

Annotations.

Arrows.

It looked less like engineering...

...and more like a maze.

He carefully folded it...

...and slipped it into his jacket pocket.

Then he locked the room again.

Returned the key.

Said nothing.

The rest of the trip felt normal.

Photos from Kalighat flooded the SUS GC.

One picture showed Tanish standing beside a priest.

Their expressions couldn't have been more different.

Everyone laughed.

They returned home.

Had dinner.

Later that night they sat together on the rooftop.

Kolkata nights carried a strange kind of peace.

Om barely spoke.

Nobody noticed.

Om had always been quiet.

The blueprint remained inside his pocket.

Back in Delhi.

IKS.

His office.

His desk.

Om unfolded the blueprint.

Spread it across the table.

He stared at it for hours.

Then activated SAHAY.

"SAHAY."

"Look at this."

The camera scanned the pages.

Processing...

A few moments later—

"...This..."

SAHAY finally spoke.

"This is Ishaan's handwriting."

A brief pause.

"Om..."

"This is the blueprint for a **Universal Teleporter**."

"A Universal Teleporter?"

"A device capable of transporting any person or object from one location to another without physical movement."

"Ishaan designed this before creating SAHAY."

"Back in Kolkata."

"When he was only in seventh or eighth grade."

Om looked back at the blueprint.

A child had imagined this.

A child who spent his days playing cricket...

...and his nights solving impossible equations.

"I can build it."

"Om..."

For the first time...

There was genuine concern in SAHAY's voice.

"Ishaan's mind is beyond your imagination."

"This blueprint is extraordinarily complex."

"If even a single calculation is wrong..."

"...the consequences could be catastrophic."

"A malfunction could trigger a matter-antimatter collision."

"I strongly advise against attempting this."

Om remained silent.

Then asked only one question.

"Is it theoretically possible?"

A long silence followed.

"...Yes."

"Then I'm building it."

Days turned into nights.

Nights into calculations.

SAHAY handled simulations.

Om handled construction.

During the day...

IKS work.

At night...

The blueprint.

He forgot meals.

Ignored sleep.

The same relentless routine that had begun the day he came home with **80%**.

Finally...

The device was complete.

It looked surprisingly ordinary.

Small.

Simple.

Almost unimpressive.

Yet it was supposed to perform something impossible.

Om inhaled deeply.

Pressed the button.

A soft humming sound.

Then...

Nothing.

No teleportation.

No signal.

No response.

He tried again.

And again.

And again.

Nothing.

Om sat there silently...

Holding the device in his hands.

The room was filled with the kind of silence that only exists after immense hope collapses into disappointment.

He had failed.

SAHAY said nothing.

Perhaps it knew...

Words would never be enough.

Om gently placed the device back onto the table.

Outside...

Delhi's night remained unchanged.

Inside...

Only a disappointed man...

...and a blueprint imagined by an eighth-grade genius—

A blueprint that perhaps...

...the world still wasn't ready to understand.

Chapter 2: Repetition

Morning light filled the room.

Om sat silently before the table.

The failed device rested in front of him.

The blueprint was spread across the desk.

The emptiness from the previous night still lingered.

Just then—

The door opened.

Gauri walked in.

She carried two cups of coffee.

Without saying a word, she handed one to Om.

She sat down, took a sip, and asked directly,

"When SAHAY warned you... why did you still try?"

Om held the cup for a moment.

"How do you know?"

Gauri looked at him with an expression that almost said,

"Are you seriously asking that?"

"Om."

"You entrusted me with SAHAY's maintenance."

"I'm a software engineer."

"Every activity SAHAY performs is logged for me."

"I saw your entire conversation."

Om remained silent.

"So?"

"Why was it necessary?"

There was no anger in her voice.

Only genuine curiosity.

"It belonged to Ishaan," Om replied quietly.

"Ishaan designed it... when he was in eighth grade."

"Before SAHAY."

"If he could think of something like that..."

"So what?"

Om placed his coffee on the table.

"...Then maybe I could too."

Before he could finish—

Something strange happened.

A vibration spread through his body.

It felt as if an invisible frequency had awakened inside him.

He looked at his hands.

They were perfectly normal.

But the room—

The room began to shake.

Or perhaps...

...he was the one shaking.

Gauri called his name.

Her voice drifted farther and farther away.

As though someone was slowly lowering the volume of reality itself.

Then—

Darkness.

When Om opened his eyes...

He wasn't in his room anymore.

It was another place.

Another room.

Clean.

Organized.

Unfamiliar.

Across the room sat a young man.

A laptop lay open before him.

A cup of tea rested beside it.

Om looked once.

Then twice.

Ishaan.

But...

Not the Ishaan from IKS.

This version looked younger.

His eyes didn't carry the unbearable weight of thousands of years of war.

This was simply...

A normal young man working peacefully.

Ishaan looked up.

His eyes met Om's.

"Who are you?"

Before Om could answer—

A voice came from behind.

"What was that sound?"

"Did you drop something?"

Om turned around.

The ground seemed to disappear beneath his feet.

Avika.

The same face.

The same eyes.

Exactly as she'd appeared in the photographs.

Alive.

Healthy.

Smiling.

Completely normal.

Om couldn't understand anything.

Where was he?

What was happening?

Then SAHAY spoke.

"Om."

"We have been teleported into another universe."

"The device worked."

"Just... not in the way we expected."

Ishaan heard every word.

He froze.

Then slowly looked at Om.

"...Is that SAHAY?"

Om nodded.

For a brief moment...

Tears filled Ishaan's eyes.

"...This..."

"...This was my dream."

"What do you mean?"

Om asked.

Ishaan took a deep breath.

"Sit."

"I'll explain."

The three of them sat together.

Avika made fresh coffee.

Three cups.

She sat on one side.

Om on the other.

Ishaan between them.

"When I scored well in my Class 10 board exams..."

"I was told..."

'Become successful first.

Follow your passion later.'

"My dream was building SAHAY."

"Artificial Intelligence."

"Programming."

He slowly rotated the coffee cup in his hands.

"Today..."

"I am successful."

"But I never found time for my dream."

"Life took me somewhere else."

Silence filled the room.

Om stared at him.

The same face.

The same person.

Yet...

An entirely different life.

Avika looked toward Om.

"Why were you so shocked after seeing me?"

Om was about to answer—

But Ishaan gently raised his hand.

"Wait."

He looked directly at Om.

"It's fine to talk about the past."

"But knowing the future..."

"...can be dangerous."

"We shouldn't interfere with this universe."

Om understood.

He nodded.

Still...

His chest felt heavy.

Avika sat there—

Alive.

Happy.

Completely unaware.

And Om knew...

He could never tell her the truth.

Even without SAHAY...

Ishaan was extraordinary.

Suddenly—

A warning appeared inside SAHAY.

"Om."

"I've detected an unexpected frequency."

"What frequency?"

"The same one I detected years ago..."

"In France."

"When the alien pod crashed."

Om immediately straightened.

Ishaan heard that.

"Alien pod?"

"What happened in France?"

"A few years from now..."

Om answered.

"But if this really is the same frequency..."

"...then it means..."

"...someone is coming."

SAHAY completed the sentence.

Ishaan looked outside the window.

The sky remained perfectly normal.

"This has never happened before."

"Nothing like this has ever occurred in our universe."

Om looked at both of them.

"I have to explain everything."

He told them everything.

INDOVAR.

The Rakshas.

Their planet.

Their armies.

The seven-thousand-year-old war.

Neither Ishaan nor Avika interrupted once.

When Om finished—

Ishaan remained silent for a moment.

"Then..."

"We have to stop them."

"Before they enter orbit."

"Exactly."

"We'll need an aircraft."

"One equipped with a destroyer capable of targeting their core."

Ishaan looked at Om.

Then at SAHAY.

Then back at Om.

"...Then let's build one."

The work began.

Ishaan and Om worked side by side.

Avika kept bringing materials.

SAHAY handled every calculation.

Night.

Day.

Another night.

Finally—

The aircraft was complete.

Vimaan 2.

Compact.

Fast.

Armed with a destroyer capable of destroying an alien core in a single strike.

"I'll go."

Om said.

Ishaan simply looked at him.

Then nodded.

Vimaan 2 left Earth's atmosphere.

Om sat alone inside the cockpit.

Only SAHAY accompanied him.

Soon—

The alien vessel appeared.

Massive.

Dark.

Terrifying.

It had entered Earth's orbit...

...but hadn't fully stabilized yet.

"SAHAY."

"Target lock."

"Locked."

Om placed his finger over the firing button.

Took a deep breath.

Suddenly—

A beam shot out from the alien ship.

Direct hit.

CRASH.

Vimaan 2 slammed directly into the alien vessel.

Smoke.

Sparks.

Warning alarms.

Om unbuckled himself.

Forced the hatch open.

Stepped inside.

Darkness.

Thousands of aliens.

Every one of them rushed toward him.

Om had no weapons.

No Astra Ring.

Only the bracelet Ishaan had gifted him on his wedding day.

The one embedded with the mysterious gemstone.

The aliens drew closer.

Then—

The bracelet glowed.

A brilliant burst of purple light erupted from it.

A massive energy beam swept through the corridor.

Everything standing in its path collapsed instantly.

Silence.

Om stared at the bracelet.

It continued glowing...

Slowly.

Softly.

"SAHAY..."

"What was that?"

"Later."

"Destroy the ship first."

Om advanced deeper into the vessel.

Again...

And again...

The bracelet protected him.

Finally...

He reached the control room.

"SAHAY."

"Any way to destroy the ship?"

"There is only one."

"Activate the self-destruct sequence."

"I can do it now."

Om froze.

"But..."

"I'm still inside."

"Yes."

SAHAY didn't soften the truth.

It simply stated the fact.

Om thought for a moment.

His hands trembled slightly.

No.

There had to be another way.

"Any other option?"

"Only one."

"Set the timer."

"Escape in an emergency pod."

"Can we set a timer?"

"Minimum: three minutes."

"Do it."

"I'll escape."

SAHAY activated the sequence.

03:00

02:59

02:58

Om sprinted toward the escape pods.

Corridor after corridor.

The bracelet emitted a faint glow—

Almost as if it were guiding him.

Finally—

The pod chamber.

He reached the door.

Just as he was about to climb inside—

An Alien Commander appeared.

Larger.

Heavier.

Completely fearless.

It grabbed Om with one arm...

...and hurled him across the room.

Om crashed into the opposite wall.

The Commander entered the pod.

The hatch sealed.

The pod launched.

Om watched helplessly.

The timer continued.

00:10

00:09

00:08

Now what?

00:03

00:02

00:01

BOOM.

The alien ship vanished in a blinding explosion.

Om floated through open space.

No oxygen.

No spacecraft.

Only darkness.

And countless stars.

Then—

The bracelet reacted.

A purple energy field instantly surrounded him.

Oxygen filled the barrier.

Warmth returned.

A personal shield.

Made only for him.

Om floated silently in space.

Alive.

Unable to believe it.

"SAHAY..."

he whispered.

"What exactly is this bracelet?"

SAHAY remained silent for a moment.

Then replied quietly,

"I don't know, Om."

"But whatever it is..."

"...Ishaan knew one day..."

"...you would need it."

Chapter 3: Tidnap

Floating through space, Om spotted something.

The escape pod.

The Commander was inside it.

It was racing toward Earth.

Fast.

Directly.

"SAHAY."

"Track the pod."

"Tracked."

"It's heading toward Egypt."

Om looked at the bracelet.

It was still glowing.

The purple energy field still surrounded him.

"Can I land directly using this energy field?"

"Theoretically, yes."

"But you won't control the landing."

"The bracelet will decide."

Om thought for a moment.

There was no other option.

"Let's go."

The pod landed in the Egyptian desert.

It was night.

Sand stretched endlessly in every direction.

Far away, an unfamiliar light flickered across the dunes.

A few seconds later...

Om landed as well.

Straight into the sand.

Sinking nearly to his knees.

The Commander stepped out of the pod.

He saw Om.

For a brief moment...

He looked surprised.

Then he smiled.

The kind of smile that never means anything good.

"So..."

"You made it all the way here."

The Universal Translator activated through SAHAY.

"Seeing you reminds me of an ancient story told by our ancestors."

"A creature..."

"Half human."

"Half ape."

Om smiled faintly.

"Very interesting history."

"But right now..."

"You're standing on our planet."

"And you weren't invited."

The Commander said nothing.

He charged.

Fast.

Heavy.

Om simply raised his hand.

The bracelet responded.

A massive purple beam burst forward.

The Commander disappeared inside it.

Gone.

Completely erased.

Nothing remained.

Only sand.

And silence.

Om looked down at his hand.

It was trembling.

Not from fear.

From the overwhelming energy that had just been released.

He was about to return...

Back to Ishaan and Avika...

When the familiar sensation returned.

The vibration.

The glitch.

"No..."

"Not now..."

His body ignored him.

Darkness.

When Om opened his eyes...

He found himself inside a cage.

A transparent, high-tech prison.

The walls looked like glass...

But the instant he touched one...

Electricity surged through it.

A bright white light hung directly above.

Om looked at his wrist.

The bracelet was gone.

"SAHAY?"

he whispered.

No response.

SAHAY was gone too.

He looked around.

Outside the cage stood several guards.

Different uniforms.

A different universe.

Om sat quietly.

Then—

Footsteps.

A familiar face appeared.

Gauri.

But...

Not *his* Gauri.

She wore a military uniform.

Her expression was cold.

Professional.

Her eyes carried no warmth.

"You're awake."

Her tone was purely official.

"Gauri..."

"Why am I imprisoned?"

"What are you people doing?"

She stopped.

"...How do you know my name?"

Only then did Om realize.

This Gauri had never met him.

Another universe.

Another life.

He was about to explain—

When a loud announcement echoed throughout the facility.

"Supreme Leader is arriving."

"Everyone kneel."

Every guard immediately dropped to one knee.

Gauri did the same.

Only Om remained standing inside the cage.

Confused.

Without the bracelet.

Without SAHAY.

The main door opened.

A giant entered.

Nearly seven feet tall.

Old...

Yet his presence alone made the entire room feel smaller.

His ceremonial robes belonged to a civilization that clearly considered itself superior.

Later...

Om would learn his real name.

Kiaririkakato.

But everyone simply called him...

Tidnap.

He examined Om carefully.

From head to toe.

Then turned toward the guards.

"He's a Rakshas."

"Kill him."

The guards advanced.

"Wait!"

Om shouted.

The guards stopped.

Tidnap raised one hand.

"Speak."

"I'm not a Rakshas."

"And judging from everything I've seen..."

"There is no Ishaan in your universe."

"That's why you're confused."

Tidnap's expression hardened instantly.

"Do not speak our God's name with your filthy tongue."

Om became even more confused.

God?

Ishaan is worshipped as God here?

Which Ishaan?

Gauri doesn't know me.

They keep calling me a Rakshas.

Nothing made sense.

The guards advanced again.

Then—

Gauri spoke.

"Tidnap."

Her voice was calm.

Confident.

Everyone stopped.

Tidnap turned toward her.

"What is it?"

"You possess far greater wisdom than any of us."

"But I'd like to say something."

Tidnap gestured for her to continue.

"At night..."

"The powers of Rakshasas become stronger."

"If we execute him now..."

"Our sacred sanctuary will be filled with negative energy."

"Execute him tomorrow morning."

"That would be more appropriate."

Tidnap studied her.

Then looked back at Om.

Several moments passed.

"Tomorrow morning."

He turned...

And walked away.

Night.

Om sat alone inside the cage.

Silence surrounded him.

Guards stood outside.

There was no need to wonder what tomorrow morning meant.

He already knew.

No SAHAY.

No bracelet.

Gauri didn't recognize him.

Nobody knew who he was.

And Ishaan—

The one who was apparently worshipped as God in this universe—

Where was he?

Then...

Soft footsteps.

Careful footsteps.

Gauri.

This time...

She wasn't wearing her uniform.

Only ordinary clothes.

She carried two things.

A device.

And something painfully familiar.

The bracelet.

She quietly unlocked the cage.

Without making a sound.

Stepped inside.

"Stay quiet."

Om nodded.

She handed him SAHAY's device.

Then the bracelet.

The moment Om wore it again...

A familiar warmth spread through his body.

"Why are you helping me?"

he whispered.

Gauri remained silent for a few seconds.

Then answered,

"We have a sacred book."

"It was written by our God..."

"Ishaan."

"It contains everything."

"Science."

"Ethics."

"Laws."

"Our entire civilization follows it."

"But?"

Om asked.

"But people have twisted its meaning."

"What Ishaan wrote..."

"...is not what Tidnap is doing."

Her voice carried genuine pain.

"I've read that book thousands of times."

"Nowhere does it say..."

'Kill every Rakshas.'

Om listened quietly.

Then activated SAHAY.

"Status report."

SAHAY paused briefly.

"Om..."

"Once..."

"Ishaan told me something."

"He said..."

'Time doesn't always make people wiser.

Sometimes it pushes them in the wrong direction.

And to hide their own darkness...

they begin using religion.'

Another pause.

"It seems..."

"This universe became exactly that."

Gauri heard every word.

Her eyes filled with tears.

But none fell.

She looked at Om once more.

"How..."

"How do you know my name?"

This time...

There was no official tone.

Only curiosity.

Only a question.

Om was about to answer—

When the vibration returned.

Again.

No...

Not again.

Not now...

Gauri watched as Om's face changed.

"Are you alright—"

Darkness.

Chapter 4: Home

When Om opened his eyes—

He was somewhere familiar.

He looked once.

Then twice.

Then a third time.

This was it.

The same gate.

The same wall with a patch of peeled paint.

The same window from which the warm light of his home used to spill out every night.

His home.

Om stood there.

He couldn't move.

He couldn't speak.

His eyes filled with tears—and this time, he couldn't stop them.

They fell without warning.

He just wanted to keep looking.

At that gate.

At that wall.

At that window.

Mom must be inside.

Dad must be inside.

Then a voice came from behind.

"Excuse me, sir... could you please move away from the gate?"

Om turned around.

It was his mother.

Wearing a simple saree.

A bag of vegetables in one hand.

And in the other...

the hand of a nine-year-old boy.

That boy.

Om looked at him—

and for a single moment...

the entire world stopped.

It wasn't just any child.

It was **him**.

Nine-year-old Om.

The same face.

The same eyes.

Without saying a word, Om stepped aside.

He knew.

He couldn't interfere.

Whatever destiny had written...

had to happen exactly as it was meant to.

His mother glanced at him—

at the older Om—

with nothing more than the casual look she'd give a stranger.

Then she walked inside,

holding little Om's hand.

The door closed.

Om remained standing outside.

"SAHAY..."

he whispered, his voice trembling.

"Yes, Om."

"The T-shirt..."

the one little Om was wearing...

I remember it.

I had that exact T-shirt when I was nine."

"Yes."

"...Which means this is 2023."

"Yes, Om.

You're standing in your own past—

the past of a parallel universe."

Om let out a long breath.

"That means..."

Ishaan must have already arrived in Delhi.

Right now."

"Logically..."

yes."

"And his mind..."

Om paused.

"When I was nine..."

the things I thought about don't even compare to the way I think today.

Then Ishaan..."

"...Ishaan's mind would still be far ahead of yours today," SAHAY finished.

Om looked back at his house.

The door was closed.

But the lights were still on inside.

"Give me Ishaan's address."

There was an ordinary apartment building in the same neighborhood.

Nothing about it looked special.

Om rang the doorbell.

The door opened.

Bhuvan.

A much younger Bhuvan.

A college student.

Not an ISRO scientist yet.

Just... a normal young man.

"Who are you?"

"It's a long story," Om replied.

"Can I explain it inside?"

Bhuvan hesitated for a moment.

Then stepped aside.

"Come in."

Only Bhuvan was home.

Om explained everything.

The Universal Teleporter.

The glitches.

The parallel universes.

Tidnap.

Egypt.

Everything.

Bhuvan listened quietly.

He didn't interrupt even once.

When Om finally finished,

Bhuvan sat silently for a moment.

"Where's Ishaan?" Om asked.

Bhuvan's expression changed instantly.

"He...

he's at the hospital.

With Mom and Dad."

"...Why?"

Bhuvan took a deep breath.

"A few days ago...

he went to the cricket ground alone in the evening."

He stopped.

"When he didn't return for hours...

we went looking for him."

Another pause.

"We found him there.

But...

he wasn't okay."

"There was something all over his body...

red electricity...

constantly flowing."

"His eyes were open...

but he wasn't seeing anything."

"He tried to speak...

but no words came out."

Om's mind immediately started racing.

Red electricity.

Constant.

Doctors couldn't identify it.

"How many days?" Om asked.

"Three."

The doorbell rang.

Bhuvan walked toward the entrance.

Om stayed seated,

thinking.

A continuous red electrical current...

This isn't a medical condition.

This is something else.

Something this universe has probably never seen before.

Voices echoed from outside.

Bhuvan was talking to someone.

Then—

fast footsteps.

Om stood up—

when suddenly...

a small boy—

around nine years old—

ran straight toward him.

In one swift motion—

he snatched the bracelet.

Right off Om's wrist.

"Wait!"

Om rushed after him.

"Please!

Give that back!"

The boy stopped.

The bracelet rested quietly in his hand.

Then Om saw his eyes.

A strange glow.

Red.

Electric.

Ishaan.

Nine-year-old Ishaan.

The same child who had supposedly been "unwell" for the past three days.

The same crimson current flowed through his eyes.

Now the bracelet was in his hand.

And he was staring directly at Om.

As if...

he recognized him.

As if...

he already knew him.

"Please..."

Om slowly extended his hand.

"Give it back."

And then—

his body vibrated again.

The glitch.

"No..."

not now..."

Ishaan has the bracelet...

SAHAY—

Darkness.

Chapter 5: Demons' Universe

Darkness.

Nothing but darkness.

Om opened his eyes—

but it made no difference.

There was no light.

No sound.

Just endless black.

Where am I?

Then—

a faint whimper echoed somewhere in the distance.

Then another.

Instinctively, Om reached for his wrist.

The bracelet.

Nothing.

Only bare skin.

The bracelet...

It's still with Ishaan.

For a brief second, it didn't register.

Then reality hit him.

No bracelet means...

No shield.

No energy beam.

No protection.

Shapes began emerging from the darkness.

One.

Then three.

Then hundreds.

Demons.

Every one of them moving in the same direction—

straight toward Om.

He stepped backward.

There was nowhere to go.

Only more darkness.

This is where it ends.

And then—

BOOM!

An explosion so immense that, for a single moment, the entire Demon Universe was drowned in light.

Every demon charging toward Om—

gone.

Erased.

Silence.

Om slowly turned around.

A man stood there.

He held a strange-looking weapon.

His clothes were torn.

His eyes carried exhaustion...

but also a determination that felt strangely familiar.

Then Om saw his face.

His own face.

But different.

Older.

More worn.

As if life had taken far more from him.

Another Om.

"Come here. Quickly," the other Om said.

"You can explain later how you ended up here."

Inside a ruined laboratory.

The same dim lights.

The same eerie silence.

*(To avoid confusion from this point onward, we'll refer to the Om from the Main Universe as **Om-1**, and the Om from the Demon Universe as **Om-2**.)*

Om-1 explained everything.

The Universal Teleporter.

The glitches.

Egypt.

Tidnap.

Ishaan's house.

The bracelet.

Everything.

Om-2 listened quietly.

When Om-1 finished, Om-2 let out a tired sigh.

"I think..."

he said,

"...this is the third... maybe fourth time in the last twenty-four hours that I've heard this exact story."

Without another word, Om-2 walked to a drawer.

He pulled out a small device.

Flat.

Circular.

"Hold out your hand."

"What is this?"

"Just do it."

Om-1 extended his arm.

Click.

The device locked itself around his wrist.

It tightened automatically.

"You won't jump to another universe anymore," Om-2 said.

"This device locks the glitch pattern in your body."

"How do you know about something like this?" Om-1 asked.

Om-2 paused.

"A few years ago...

the Ishaan from your universe came here."

"He was building this device for the first time."

"But do you know why he understood it so well?"

"Because he had already designed it long before."

"He'd even worked on it while he was here."

"He talked to me about this exact problem.

And he also told me the solution."

"So what do I have to do?"

"The device I've attached to you isn't enough."

"You'll have to stay in **deep freeze** for at least one to two months."

"Only then will it stabilize completely."

Om-1 looked down at the device.

At that moment, SAHAY spoke.

"I was with Ishaan back then too.

Why don't I remember any of this?"

Om-2 looked toward SAHAY.

"There are many things you don't know."

"Back then, Ishaan ordered you to focus entirely on the creation of **Wagt-Bandh**."

"When you're in Focus Mode...

you ignore everything unrelated."

"Oh..."

SAHAY replied awkwardly.

"Right..."

Then Om-2 frowned.

"But something else you mentioned..."

"The red current in young Ishaan's eyes..."

"It reminds me of something."

SAHAY answered immediately.

"It reminds me too."

"Before Ishaan fought Manvik inside the Dimensional Nexus..."

"Manvik admitted that he had once fallen into a universe..."

"...where he absorbed the knowledge of a young Ishaan."

Both Oms froze.

Neither spoke.

Then Om-2 whispered,

"So that red current..."

"...was Manvik," Om-1 finished.

"Or at least..."

Manvik's influence...

inside young Ishaan."

Silence.

A silence so heavy...

that even the endless fog of the Demon Universe felt lighter.

Om-2 picked up another device.

Waqt-Bandh.

He placed it in Om-1's hand.

"Go back to your universe."

"And head straight into deep freeze."

"One to two months."

"Don't come out before that."

"But what about everything happening in that universe—"

"Whatever is meant to happen..."

Om-2 said calmly,

"...will happen."

There was no drama in his voice.

Only the cold acceptance of someone who had witnessed too much.

Om-1 looked at him one last time.

The same face.

The same eyes.

Yet...

a completely different man.

Will I become like him one day?

He activated Waqt-Bandh.

The laboratory.

His laboratory.

Familiar.

Safe.

Bhuvan.

Mikhail.

Gauri.

Kenji.

All four were studying different screens when they suddenly noticed him.

They rushed toward him.

"Om!"

"Where were you?"

"You've been missing for three days!"

"Three days?"

Om asked in disbelief.

"Yeah!

Three whole days!

Gauri told us you suddenly disappeared—we've been searching everywhere!"

"I'll explain everything later," Om said.

"First...

there's something important."

He told them the entire story—

a shortened version.

The glitches.

The universes.

Om-2.

The stabilizing device.

Deep freeze.

When he finished,

Kenji asked the first question.

"For how long?"

"One to two months."

Bhuvan looked at Om for a moment.

Then nodded.

Gauri was about to say something—

but Om spoke first.

"I'll be okay."

"And I'll come back."

"But this has to be done."

In one corner of the laboratory stood a specialized chamber.

An advanced piece of IKS technology.

Originally designed for medical emergencies.

Deep Freeze.

Om stepped inside.

Bhuvan checked the controls.

Mikhail adjusted the temperature.

Kenji looked at Om one last time.

Then quietly said,

"Come back."

Om smiled.

The chamber door slowly sealed shut.

Cold air began filling the chamber.

Little by little.

His eyelids grew heavier.

The final thought that crossed his mind was—

Young Ishaan's glowing red eyes.

Manvik's influence.

The bracelet is still with Ishaan.

One... maybe two months.

Then... we'll see.

His eyes closed.

NAVMANI
ARC

Chapter 1: Interlude

A faint blue light glowed inside the deep-freeze chamber—soft, slow, almost as if it were breathing.

Om was inside.

It had only been two days.

But outside... nothing had stopped.

Gauri sat alone in one corner of the lab. Her laptop was open, yet she wasn't really looking at the screen. Her eyes were fixed on it, but her mind was somewhere else.

What had happened?

How had Om disappeared for three entire days?

And now this deep freeze... without telling them the full story?

Kenji had already left for the USA. Officially, it was for work. Or maybe for another reason—no one had really asked.

After his departure, every responsibility—IKS, the hospital, everything—had fallen onto Bhuvan and Mikhail.

And those shoulders felt much heavier than before.

Sanjivani had already been launched.

The new hospital.

The revolutionary device.

Everything had looked perfect on inauguration day.

But within a few weeks...

Things started changing.

Cases began appearing.

Not many.

But enough that they couldn't be ignored.

Several patients who had undergone treatment through Sanjivani began showing strange side effects—unexplained symptoms that had never been documented before.

The media caught the story immediately.

Headlines appeared everywhere.

"Was IKS's revolutionary device launched too early?"

News debates began.

Experts questioned its safety.

Journalists demanded answers.

Doctors raised concerns.

Investors wanted explanations.

Day and night, Bhuvan and Mikhail answered calls.

The problem was...

They didn't have the answers themselves.

Then...

Almost overnight...

Everything became quiet.

A small coaching teacher was suddenly caught in some local controversy.

A completely unrelated scandal.

The media instantly shifted its attention.

The Sanjivani story disappeared.

As if it had never existed.

For Bhuvan and Mikhail, it was a relief.

But it was a strange kind of relief.

Because the real question—

Why were the side effects happening?

—still had no answer.

Late that night...

Three people sat inside the lab.

Bhuvan.

Mikhail.

Gauri.

Three cups of coffee rested on the table.

All of them had gone cold.

Mikhail looked at Gauri.

"Did you find anything?"

"About whatever happened to Om?"

Gauri slowly shook her head.

"No."

Her voice carried exhaustion.

For the last two days...

She had done nothing except search, analyze, think, and question herself.

She had found...

Nothing.

Silence filled the room.

After a while, Bhuvan rubbed his tired eyes.

"The Sanjivani cases are increasing."

"We have to solve this as soon as possible."

"Otherwise this won't remain just a PR problem."

There was more than fatigue in his voice.

There was fear.

Tiny footsteps echoed through the room.

Avika.

Still sleepy, carrying a sheet of paper in her hands, she walked straight to Bhuvan and climbed into his lap.

"Papa... look."

She handed him the drawing.

Bhuvan smiled.

It was a crayon painting.

Five colorful figures stood together in one line.

"And who are these?" he asked.

Avika pointed one by one.

"This is Grandpa Kenji."

"This is you, Papa."

"This is Mummy."

"This is Uncle Om."

"And this is Aunty Gauri."

The room fell silent.

For just a moment.

"Keep it with you," Avika said, placing the drawing into Bhuvan's hands.

"I'm going to sleep now."

Bhuvan accepted it carefully...

As if it were something priceless.

He slipped it into the inside pocket of his jacket.

"Good night, sweetheart."

Avika walked away.

Silence returned to the room.

But somehow...

It felt different now.

Everyone eventually went to their rooms.

The next morning...

Gauri returned to work.

The monitors were filled with data.

Her fingers moved across the keyboard.

But her thoughts remained exactly where they had been.

Om.

Those missing three days.

His impossible disappearance.

Then...

An idea struck her.

She opened SAHAY's interface.

"SAHAY."

"You can explain everything in detail, right?"

"What exactly happened to Om during those three days?"

SAHAY paused.

"I can."

"But if I do..."

"I'll have to shut down every live system I'm currently running."

Gauri froze.

Elsewhere...

Mikhail stood outside the IKS headquarters.

As usual, Sanjivani trucks were leaving the facility, carrying medicines and medical devices.

She watched them absentmindedly.

Just another normal morning.

Then...

Something felt wrong.

The main distributor truck—

A route she had seen thousands of times—

Wasn't taking its usual road.

It was moving...

In the exact opposite direction.

Her mind stopped for a second.

That's the wrong route.

She watched a little longer to make sure.

No mistake.

It was the same truck.

Heading the wrong way.

Mikhail immediately ran inside.

Straight to Bhuvan.

"Bhuvan!"

"The main Sanjivani distributor truck..."

"It's not following its normal route."

"It's heading in the opposite direction."

Bhuvan's expression hardened instantly.

"Since when?"

"I just saw it."

He didn't waste even a second.

"SAHAY."

"Track that truck."

"Now."

"Tracking..." SAHAY replied.

A map appeared on the screen.

A moving dot began traveling across it.

Then—

Midway—

SAHAY's voice stopped.

The screen froze.

"SAHAY?"

Bhuvan called.

No response.

Bhuvan and Mikhail exchanged confused looks.

Then Bhuvan turned toward Gauri.

She was standing silently in the corner.

Because Gauri had just assigned SAHAY to something else.

Chapter 2: Wabistan

Bhuvan's expression hardened.

"What have you done, Gauri?"

Gauri looked at him.

Her eyes showed exhaustion, but her voice remained steady.

"SAHAY isn't permanently offline."

"Just let me examine the data from those three missing days."

"It'll come back online afterward."

She turned toward the door.

"Let me go now."

"The longer we wait...

the more time we'll lose."

Without giving anyone a chance to respond, she walked away.

Bhuvan remained standing there.

Nothing made sense anymore.

The truck's tracking had stopped midway.

SAHAY was offline.

And now Gauri had gone off on her own.

Mikhail gently placed a hand on his shoulder.

"We'll figure something out, Bhuvan."

"For now...

we need to do something else."

Bhuvan took a deep breath.

There was no time to waste.

He immediately called his men.

"Search the entire area."

"Every road."

"Every corner."

"Anywhere that truck could've gone."

His team left immediately.

Six...

maybe seven hours passed.

When they finally returned...

every face looked exhausted.

And empty-handed.

"Sir..."

"We searched the entire area."

"There was nothing."

Bhuvan looked carefully at them.

Something felt...

missing.

"Did you search the Wabistan area?"

Silence.

The men exchanged nervous glances.

Finally, one of them spoke softly.

"Sir..."

nobody goes there."

"Why?"

Bhuvan's voice carried both curiosity...

and irritation.

The man stepped forward.

"Sir...

let me tell you the real story."

Bhuvan nodded.

"Many years ago...

only three or four families lived in Wabistan."

"It was a small, peaceful village."

"Then one day...

the government decided to build a hospital there."

"The entire village had to be evacuated."

"Everyone agreed."

"There were no arguments."

"One of the villagers owned a roadside restaurant."

"He promised that while construction continued...

his dhaba would provide food for the workers."

"It went on like that for some time."

"Then one night..."

"One of the restaurant workers went to deliver food."

"He fell from the roof of the construction site."

"He died instantly."

Bhuvan listened without interrupting.

"After that..."

"Construction was never completed."

"Every investor involved in the project..."

"died."

"One after another."

"No confirmed illness."

"No clear accident."

"Every death remained unexplained."

"The villagers say..."

"his spirit still haunts that place."

"It never lets anyone enter."

"They call it..."

"Mahosasur."

"That's why, sir..."

"no one goes there."

Bhuvan finally exploded.

"What kind of nonsense is this?!"

he shouted, slamming his hand onto the table.

"Ghosts don't exist!"

"None of this is real!"

The room fell silent.

Every man lowered his head.

No one spoke.

At that moment...

Mikhail entered the room.

She looked around once before speaking calmly.

"I'm sorry."

"Could all of you please wait outside for a while?"

The men quietly left.

Some looked relieved.

Others simply walked away in silence.

Mikhail walked toward Bhuvan.

"Why are you yelling at them?"

Her voice wasn't loud.

But it was firm.

"They have families waiting for them too."

"They don't want to risk their lives."

"There's nothing wrong with that."

Bhuvan shook his head in frustration.

"Ghosts aren't real, Mikhail."

"They simply don't exist."

Mikhail remained silent for a moment.

Then she looked directly into his eyes.

"There was a time..."

she said softly,

"...when you believed God didn't exist either."

She paused.

"Today..."

"...your own brother has become a God."

For the first time...

Bhuvan had no reply.

Chapter 3: The Night at Hospital

Dinner was served on the table.

Bhuvan and Mikhail sat together after an exhausting day. A simple meal—dal, rice, and a vegetable curry. Night had already fallen outside, and the room was lit only by the faint glow of the television.

They had barely eaten a few bites when the volume on the TV suddenly increased.

A news anchor appeared on the screen, her expression tense, her voice urgent.

"Breaking News — SAHAY is offline. Reports regarding defects in Sanjivani, along with Om's prolonged absence from the media... Is this the beginning of IKS's downfall?"

A red ticker raced across the bottom of the screen, one headline after another, as if counting down to something inevitable.

Bhuvan's hand froze.

The piece of bread remained half-torn between his fingers.

He looked at Mikhail.

For the first time, she saw something in his eyes she had never witnessed before—a mixture of anxiety, anger, and helplessness, all at once.

He didn't say a word.

He simply pushed his plate aside, his chair scraping loudly across the floor as he stood.

"Bhuvan..." Mikhail called.

But he had already picked up the car keys.

The garage was dark, illuminated by a single dim light.

Bhuvan walked straight toward the driver's seat.

"Where are you going this late at night?" Mikhail asked, following him.

"Wabistan," he answered without hesitation.

"At night?" Her voice grew sharper.

"Have you lost your mind? People are afraid to go there even during the day—and you're planning to go at night?"

"I don't care," Bhuvan replied as he opened the car door.

"I'm going."

Mikhail stood still for a moment.

She looked into his eyes.

That same stubborn determination...

The one Ishaan had.

The one that seemed to run through the entire family.

"Then I'm coming too," she said, walking around to the passenger side.

"I'm going with you."

Bhuvan looked at her.

There wasn't enough time to argue.

And perhaps... there was nothing left to say.

"Fine," was all he replied.

The car roared to life.

It sped through the city streets.

The bright lights slowly disappeared behind them.

Dense lights became scattered.

Scattered lights became darkness.

After nearly an hour and a half, they reached Wabistan.

The paved road ended.

A dirt road began.

The only light came from the car's headlights.

On every side lay abandoned fields, dried-up trees, and a silence that could never exist inside a city.

Then—

They saw the building.

Even in complete darkness, its size was impossible to ignore.

Massive.

Towering.

Unfinished.

The first few floors were completely built—glass, concrete, polished architecture.

But everything above them remained incomplete.

Steel rods protruded from the structure.

Scaffolding still clung to its sides.

It looked as though construction had simply stopped one day... and never resumed.

Bhuvan parked the car.

Both stepped out.

The air felt unnaturally cold.

Far colder than the weather should have been.

They walked toward the building.

Their footsteps were slow...

But neither of them stopped.

A giant rusted iron door stood before them.

Bhuvan pushed it open.

It creaked loudly as it slowly swung inward.

They entered.

And the very moment they stepped inside—

Rain began pouring outside.

Without warning.

Without clouds.

Without reason.

They froze.

The sky had been perfectly clear only moments earlier.

Now, from inside the building, they watched sheets of rain fall outside—as though the weather itself had changed its course just for them.

Then—

Something crashed onto a table.

Both turned.

An old radio had fallen from the edge of a dusty table.

The instant it hit the floor...

It switched on by itself.

A song began to play.

"Rain, rain, go away...

Come again another day...

Little Johnny wants to play..."

But it wasn't the cheerful nursery rhyme.

The melody felt...

Wrong.

Slow.

Stretched unnaturally.

Like an ancient cassette playing at the wrong speed.

Like someone...

Very far away...

Very deep below...

Was singing it.

Goosebumps rose across Mikhail's arms.

"Bhuvan..."

She quietly grabbed his arm.

"Just like in classic horror movies... the gate still hasn't closed."

"We can still leave."

"Come on... let's get out of here."

Bhuvan never looked at her.

His eyes remained fixed on the radio.

"If you want to leave," he said flatly,

"then leave."

Mikhail hesitated.

Then tightened her grip.

"Don't become the first person who dies in a horror movie."

"Please... let's go."

Bhuvan slowly turned toward her.

The exhaustion in his eyes had disappeared.

Something else had replaced it.

Something buried deep inside for a long time.

"Do you really think," he asked quietly,

"that IKS matters just because it pays our bills?"

"Or because my reputation depends on it?"

A brief silence.

"It matters..."

His voice trembled.

"...because it's the last thing my brother left behind."

Mikhail couldn't answer.

Her grip loosened.

And then—

BANG!

The entrance gate slammed shut behind them.

On its own.

As if someone outside had forced it closed.

Both of them froze.

After a long silence...

Mikhail sighed softly.

"Well..."

"The gate's closed now."

"I'm not leaving you behind anymore."

"Whatever happens..."

"We'll face it together."

Bhuvan looked at her for a brief moment.

Then both of them walked deeper into the building...

Toward the darkness waiting ahead.

Just then—

A sound echoed from the upper floor.

Something heavy.

Perhaps something falling.

Or...

Footsteps.

Slow.

Deliberate.

Heavy footsteps.

As though someone was walking across the floor above them.

Both looked upward.

Then at each other.

But their eyes reflected completely different emotions.

Fear filled Mikhail's eyes...

Clear and unmistakable.

But in Bhuvan's eyes—

There was curiosity.

As if he wanted to know what was waiting upstairs.

As if, to him...

The truth mattered more than fear.

Chapter 4: Mahosasur

The two of them climbed the staircase, step by step.

With every step they took, the sound of the rain grew louder, as if the entire building itself was breathing.

They reached the upper floor.

It was empty.

An unfinished concrete floor stretched into darkness, with pillars standing where walls were supposed to be.

The darkness was so deep that even their own hands were barely visible.

No one was there.

Nothing moved.

Mikhail's eyes drifted toward one corner.

Something stood there, completely covered with an old, dirty cloth from top to bottom.

She slowly walked toward it, every step cautious.

She pulled the cloth away.

Underneath...

...was a machine.

Old.

Covered in dust.

But unmistakable.

A Sanjivani machine.

Mikhail stopped breathing for a moment.

She turned, about to call Bhuvan—

But her voice caught in her throat.

"Bhuvan..."

That was all she managed to say.

Bhuvan ran toward her.

"What happened?"

Mikhail's hand trembled.

She simply pointed behind him.

"Turn around."

Bhuvan turned.

And standing there...

...was **Mahosasur**.

Its entire body glowed crimson, as though something inside it was burning.

Nearly eight feet tall, its head almost touched the unfinished ceiling.

Two massive black horns curved outward from its skull.

Long, black claws hung from its hands.

Bhuvan's breathing stopped.

His feet felt glued to the ground.

He couldn't move.

Mahosasur slowly raised one hand.

A simple gesture.

Suddenly—

Mikhail was thrown into the air.

In a single instant, an invisible force lifted her nearly two feet above the ground.

She floated helplessly, her legs hanging in midair.

Then...

Her eyes changed.

The pupils disappeared.

The irises vanished.

Only blank white remained.

"MIKHAIL!"

Bhuvan shouted.

Without thinking, he charged forward and punched Mahosasur directly in the chest.

Nothing happened.

Instead, a sharp pain exploded through his fist, as though he had punched a solid concrete wall.

He stumbled backward, clutching his wrist in agony.

"What are you doing?" Bhuvan yelled as he struggled back to his feet.

"Leave Mikhail alone!"

"Do whatever you want to me—

—but let her go!"

Mahosasur finally spoke.

Its voice was deep...

Heavy...

As though countless voices were speaking together.

"Do not fear."

"She will not be harmed..."

"...if you do my work."

Breathing heavily, Bhuvan asked,

"What work?"

"You will know soon enough," Mahosasur replied.

"But first...

let me tell you a story."

Meanwhile, Mikhail continued floating helplessly in the air, her empty white eyes staring into nothingness.

"Many years ago," Mahosasur began,

"a hospital was being built here."

"One night, my employer handed me some food and said,

'Take this to the workers upstairs.'"

"I reached the construction site and noticed no one on the lower floors, so I climbed to the top."

"There..."

"I overheard them discussing their plans."

"They wanted to use the underground levels of this hospital for illegal businesses."

"I wasn't meant to hear that."

"But by accident..."

I dropped a cooking pot."

"They heard the noise."

"They caught me."

"They offered me money to stay silent."

"But I was an honest man."

"I refused."

"So..."

they pushed me."

"Everyone believed I had simply fallen."

"An accident."

Mahosasur paused.

"After my death...

I became part of a new species."

"There is another dimension..."

"...called **NUPIR**."

"A realm where souls exist."

"And just like Earth...

it too has its own hierarchy."

"Its own caste system."

"But there...

status isn't inherited."

"It is earned."

"To rise through the ranks...

one must obtain a gem."

"A very powerful gem."

"So I decided...

I would obtain it."

"But finding it isn't easy."

"It requires someone with extraordinary intelligence."

"So..."

"I manipulated human minds."

"I brought Sanjivani here."

"I believed that while searching for answers, Om would eventually arrive."

"And I would make him retrieve the gem for me."

Mahosasur looked directly at Bhuvan.

"But instead...

you came."

Despite the pain in his hand, Bhuvan's mind was racing.

"If you can control human minds," he asked,

"then why are you trying to convince me?"

"Why not simply control me as well?"

Mahosasur's crimson eyes locked onto him.

The air itself seemed to grow heavier.

"The task I have chosen for you..."

"...is one that **you** must perform."

There was no room for argument in its voice.

Bhuvan glanced at Mikhail.

Still suspended in the air.

Helpless.

Her lifeless white eyes staring into emptiness.

He realized...

He had no other choice.

Chapter 5: Nawmani

Gauri sat in front of her laptop.

The screens displayed the footage—the complete data from those mysterious three days that she had retrieved through SAHAY.

Her eyes remained fixed on the recordings.

But her hands trembled.

When she finally finished watching everything...

she sat perfectly still for a long moment.

Then she reactivated SAHAY.

"SAHAY, restore everything."

"Right now."

"Restoration in progress," SAHAY replied.

Gauri immediately stood up and ran outside.

She had to tell Bhuvan and Mikhail.

Everything she had seen.

Everything she had understood.

But when she reached their room...

it was empty.

She searched the entire building.

No Bhuvan.

No Mikhail.

Then she noticed Avika standing alone in the corridor.

"Avika..."

Gauri knelt beside her.

"Where are your mom and dad?"

Avika looked at her innocently.

"I've been looking for them too."

"Dad never gave me my drawing as a gift."

For a moment...

Gauri's heart stopped.

Wabistan

Mahosasur led Bhuvan into the underground basement...

the very place where the investors had once discussed their illegal businesses.

The walls were damp.

The air was heavy.

Silence surrounded everything.

Mahosasur slowly raised one hand.

A portal opened in midair.

A circular gateway of light.

Beyond it...

an entirely different place could be seen.

"Is this NUPIR?" Bhuvan asked quietly.

Mahosasur shook his head.

"No."

"This gem is so extraordinary that it has been hidden between the pathways of universes themselves."

"Go."

Bhuvan paused.

"What is this gem called?"

Mahosasur answered,

"Different civilizations know it by different names."

"Some call it the **Divine Gem**."

"Some call it the **Philosopher's Stone**."

"But the name I like the most..."

"...is **Nawmani**."

Bhuvan stepped through the portal.

The moment he entered...

he saw something impossible.

A singularity sphere.

It was slicing through itself.

Rotating endlessly.

Cutting itself apart.

As though reality itself was breaking.

Bhuvan frowned.

"Why is it cutting itself?"

Just then, SAHAY's voice spoke beside him.

"Because Om destroyed the primary destiny of every universe he visited."

Bhuvan froze.

"SAHAY?"

"You're online?"

"Gauri completed the restoration," SAHAY replied.

"I'm operational again."

Without wasting a second, Bhuvan explained everything—

Mahosasur.

Nawmani.

The portal.

Everything.

After listening, SAHAY said,

"I know about this."

"In fact..."

"Ishaan wrote about it in a book from another universe."

"What other universe?" Bhuvan asked.

"That isn't important right now."

SAHAY continued,

"Do you know why Mahosasur didn't retrieve the gem himself?"

"Why?"

"Souls like Mahosasur can exist only on Earth and in NUPIR."

"If they enter a realm like this one..."

"...they begin to burn."

"Their powers stop working."

"That's why he couldn't simply mind-control you."

"The moment you entered this place..."

"...you were already beyond his control."

Bhuvan looked ahead.

Floating in the distance...

was Nawmani.

A tiny glowing gem suspended in midair.

But someone stood between him and the gem.

A lone guardian.

"That is the Keeper of the Gem," SAHAY explained.

"Lasers surround the area."

"The guardian remains asleep."

"But if even one laser is touched..."

"...an alarm will sound."

"And the guardian will awaken."

"That's why Mahosasur needed someone intelligent enough to disable the laser network."

Bhuvan carefully studied the entire pattern.

His mind worked rapidly.

Like solving an enormous puzzle.

Slowly...

carefully...

he navigated through the maze of lasers.

Every step calculated.

Every movement precise.

The alarm never sounded.

He finally reached out...

picked up Nawmani...

and turned back.

He stepped through the portal once again.

Mahosasur was waiting.

The moment he saw Nawmani in Bhuvan's hands...

his crimson eyes burned brighter than ever.

His entire body trembled.

Whether from excitement...

or greed...

was impossible to tell.

"Give me the gem."

He extended his hand.

"Release Mikhail first," Bhuvan answered calmly.

Mahosasur hesitated.

Then lowered Mikhail to the ground.

She collapsed, gasping for air...

but she was alive.

Conscious.

Bhuvan handed over Nawmani.

Then he looked at Mikhail.

"Go outside."

"Turn SAHAY back on."

Mikhail stood.

She looked at him one last time...

then ran.

But Bhuvan stayed where he was.

Mahosasur was so consumed by greed...

he didn't even notice.

He placed Nawmani into the pendant hanging around his neck.

The instant it connected—

Instead of filling him with power...

the gem began draining him.

Mahosasur's expression changed.

"W-What..."

"What is happening?"

Stepping backward, Bhuvan answered,

"SAHAY taught me a mantra."

"It reverses Nawmani's effects."

Mahosasur erupted with rage.

His body glowed an even darker crimson.

"You..."

"YOU BETRAYED ME!"

"You don't have your powers anymore," Bhuvan replied, staring directly into his eyes.

"You're nothing more than an eight-foot-tall body..."

"...with oversized claws."

Bhuvan sprinted toward the staircase.

Upward.

Toward the roof.

Mahosasur chased after him.

Roaring.

The moment Bhuvan reached the rooftop...

he didn't hesitate.

He jumped.

Straight off the building.

Mahosasur leaped after him.

Both fell together.

But hidden inside Bhuvan's boots...

were jet thrusters.

Just before reaching the ground—

The jets ignited.

He soared upward...

completely under control.

Below him—

Mahosasur continued falling.

Waiting on the ground...

stood Mikhail.

She held a small device.

She pressed its button.

A brilliant flash.

Mahosasur...

simply vanished.

Disintegrating into the air...

as though he had never existed.

Bhuvan landed safely.

Breathing heavily.

But finally...

at peace.

Mikhail still held the device.

"You were the one who gave me this earlier..."

she said.

Bhuvan smiled...

and nodded.

Together...

they gathered every genuine Sanjivani model—

the original, safe versions that had been built correctly—

and returned to the IKS headquarters.

The next day...

a press conference was held.

Bhuvan and Mikhail stood on the stage.

Exhausted...

but unwavering.

They revealed everything they could.

The true source of Sanjivani's defects.

The truth behind Wabistan.

Mahosasur.

Everything that could safely be disclosed.

The media listened in complete silence.

And little by little...

the reputation of IKS...

began to recover.



MISSION ANTIDOTE ARC

Chapter 1: Countdown

Today was the day.

Everyone had gathered in the lab—Bhuvan, Mikhail, Gauri, and even Kenji, who had flown back from the USA just to make sure nothing went wrong during the process.

They all stood in front of the chamber, holding their breath.

"Beginning countdown," a technician announced.

"5... 4... 3... 2... 1..."

The chamber door opened.

A wave of cold mist drifted out, and through it—

Om.

For the first two minutes, he simply stood there.

His eyes were open, but unfocused, as if a part of him was still somewhere else. His face was completely blank, like his mind hadn't finished processing reality yet.

Then, slowly...

Awareness returned.

The first person he saw was Gauri.

Without saying a single word, Om walked forward and wrapped her in a tight hug.

A hug that carried the fear, loneliness, and weight of the last two months.

Gauri's eyes filled with tears as she hugged him back just as tightly.

After a few moments, Kenji stepped forward.

"Om, we'll need to run a few diagnostic tests. Just a formality—to confirm everything is normal."

Om nodded.

The examination was thorough. Every reading was checked carefully.

Everything was normal.

When Om walked out, a smile finally appeared on his face.

"I think this deserves a party."

Everyone laughed.

The exhaustion was still there, but so was relief.

That night, a grand celebration was held.

Important members of IKS attended, along with Om and Gauri's close friends.

The entire venue glowed with lights, music echoed through the halls, and everyone knew one thing—

Om had finally returned.

The day was special for another reason too.

It was also Bhuvan and Mikhail's anniversary.

A cake was brought out.

Everyone clapped and cheered,

"Happy Anniversary!"

Bhuvan reached into his jacket pocket and took out a small box.

Inside was a simple yet beautiful locket.

He gently placed it around Mikhail's neck.

Her eyes sparkled.

No one interrupted the moment.

They simply watched... smiling.

As the night grew older, the party slowly came to an end.

Guests left one after another, laughing and exchanging goodbyes.

Soon, only the family remained—

Om.

Gauri.

Bhuvan.

Mikhail.

Kenji.

Everyone began walking toward their rooms.

Then Bhuvan stopped them.

"Wait."

Everyone turned.

"What happened?" Kenji asked.

The joy from Bhuvan's face had disappeared.

It had been replaced by something much more serious.

"I need to tell all of you something important."

He looked upward.

"SAHAY... explain."

A hologram appeared in the middle of the room.

SAHAY's voice echoed calmly.

"In movies," SAHAY began, "they often show that if someone travels into the past and changes something, a completely new timeline is created."

"That is completely incorrect."

"In reality, every decision we make already exists in another parallel universe."

"Take one example."

"In this universe, Ishaan successfully created me, and because of that, humanity survived the Indovarian invasion."

"But in another parallel universe, Ishaan failed to create me."

"And because of that failure..."

"The Indovarians destroyed that Earth."

Om looked down.

"But then," SAHAY continued,

"you entered that universe...

and changed its outcome."

The room fell silent.

"Because of your actions, that universe has started moving toward an intersection with ours."

"And it isn't just that universe."

"You unintentionally altered key events across multiple universes."

"The result is chaos."

"We have to correct it."

Om stepped forward.

"Tell me."

"What exactly went wrong in every universe...

and how do I fix it?"

The hologram transformed into a map.

Countless universes appeared as glowing spheres connected by bright lines that were slowly drifting toward one another.

"Universe One."

"You prevented the alien invasion."

"To restore the balance..."

"...you must destroy that Earth's civilization."

Om's expression hardened.

But he remained silent.

"Universe Two."

"On the day you arrived, Tidnap was supposed to attend a seminar."

"The building collapsed and he survived because of your interference."

"You must kill Tidnap."

No one spoke.

"Universe Three."

"You must take the bracelet back from young Ishaan..."

"...and drive him back into madness."

Gauri inhaled sharply.

Her eyes never left Om.

"And finally..."

"Universe Five."

"You must repair the Demon Universe."

"Because on that day..."

"Om from that universe was about to use Waqt-Bandh to create a device capable of curing
SAJ-26."

SAHAY paused.

"If these events are restored..."

"...the universes will never become exactly the way they originally were."

"But..."

"The intersections will stop."

Silence filled the room.

Only hours had passed since Om had awakened from deep freeze.

And now...

Four universes stood before him.

Each demanded an impossible choice.

Chapter 2: Mission Antidote

The very next day, everyone got to work.

Om gathered the team in the center of the lab and explained the entire plan.

"We're going to build five Waqt-Bandhs," he said, "using the same Waqt-Bandh as a reference—the one that brought me back here."

"We'll split into four teams."

"Team One — me."

"Team Two — Gauri."

"Team Three — Kenji."

"Team Four — Bhuvan and Mikhail."

He continued.

"I'll go to Universe Three to retrieve the bracelet."

"Kenji will go to Universe One to destroy Earth, so we'll send him with a protective suit and the Earth Destroyer."

"Gauri will go to Universe Two and eliminate Tidnap."

"And Bhuvan and Mikhail will go to Universe Four to return the Waqt-Bandh to Om."

Everyone nodded silently.

Within two or three days, all five Waqt-Bandhs were complete.

Now it was time.

The team stood in a circle, each wearing a Waqt-Bandh on their wrist.

Suddenly Mikhail spoke.

"Why are we being so formal?"

Om looked at her, confused.

"What do you mean?"

"I mean," she said, "in movies, missions always have names. Why don't we give this one a name too?"

Om thought for a moment but couldn't come up with anything.

Just then Avika came running.

"Mom, where are you all going?"

Mikhail crouched beside her.

"Nowhere, sweetheart. We're just going to cure the universes."

A smile appeared on Om's face.

"I've got it."

"Mission Cure."

"That's what we'll call it."

Mikhail made a face.

"That's such a boring name."

"Mission Antidote sounds much better."

Om shrugged.

"I don't care. Call it whatever you want."

Avika raised both her hands.

"Take care, everyone!"

Everyone smiled.

They formed the circle once again and activated their Waqt-Bandhs.

The countdown began.

Bhuvan chuckled softly.

"This reminds me of *Avengers: Endgame*."

Someone tried to laugh, but the tension in the room was too heavy.

"Three..."

"Two..."

"One..."

They vanished.

Kenji materialized inside Ishaan and Avika's house.

Both of them looked surprised, though it wasn't the first time someone had suddenly teleported into their home.

"You're Om's friend?" Ishaan asked.

"Yes," Kenji replied.

Before Kenji could say anything else, Ishaan spoke again.

"I'm sorry... your friend sacrificed himself fighting the aliens."

Something shook inside Kenji for a brief moment.

But he controlled himself.

If I tell him I've come to destroy Earth... he'll stop me.

So he forced a look of grief onto his face.

"Can I stay here for a little while?" he asked quietly.

Ishaan nodded.

Avika went inside to prepare coffee.

"I'll be back in two minutes," Ishaan said. "I just need to get something."

The moment Ishaan left the room, Kenji knew this was his chance.

He put on the protective suit.

Pulled out the Earth Destroyer.

He was just about to press the activation button—

When Ishaan suddenly walked back in.

Startled, Kenji dropped the device.

Ishaan looked down at it.

His expression changed.

Recognition.

"This is an Earth Destroyer," he said calmly.

"It can destroy the planet."

"But it doesn't have the fuel needed to drill through Earth's core."

He held up a small metal container.

"I have it."

"I recovered it from the wreckage of the alien ship."

Kenji stared at him in disbelief.

Then Ishaan spoke again.

"I already know."

"Nothing in time can truly be changed."

"Our end is part of destiny."

"And destiny cannot be rewritten."

Just then Avika returned with two cups of coffee.

Ishaan walked over and gently rested one hand on her shoulder.

Then he looked back at Kenji.

His voice was peaceful...

Yet unbearably heavy.

"The longer you wait..."

"...the more it will hurt."

Kenji took a deep breath.

He lowered the helmet over his head.

And pressed the button.

A blinding flash consumed everything.

In a single instant—

Earth was gone.

Chapter 3: The Darker Future

Gauri teleported.

The moment her eyes opened, she found herself in an entirely different world.

Towering glass skyscrapers stretched into the sky. Vehicles floated through the air. Brilliant lights illuminated every corner, and the level of technology was so far beyond anything she had ever seen that, for a brief moment, her mind simply froze.

She was standing in the middle of a road.

Then she noticed it.

A truck was racing straight toward her.

Fast.

Far too close.

Gauri panicked. Her feet refused to move.

At the last second, someone grabbed her wrist and yanked her backward with all their strength.

The truck sped past the exact spot where she had been standing.

Gauri slowly opened her eyes.

A young woman stood before her, worry written all over her face.

"Who are you?" Gauri asked.

The girl smiled faintly.

"You forgot me already?"

"I'm Jaayu."

"Jaayu Malviya."

"Your childhood friend."

Gauri simply stared at her.

"And when did you get out of prison?" Jaayu asked.

Gauri couldn't answer.

Then it struck her.

I'm not in my own universe.

Everything is different here.

"Jaayu," Gauri said quietly, "I'll explain everything. But first... please take me somewhere safe."

Jaayu studied her face for a moment.

She didn't understand what was happening, yet something in Gauri's eyes felt genuine.

She nodded.

The two of them got into a car.

During the drive, Jaayu started talking.

"You know," she said with a hint of complaint, "after school you completely disappeared."

"Do you remember Om from our class?"

"We got married."

"I even came to invite you to the wedding."

"But nobody was allowed inside the palace."

"They sent me away from the gate."

Gauri remained silent, trying to piece together this universe.

"And ever since you left school," Jaayu continued, "I couldn't even contact you."

"But you were one of Tidnap's favorites."

"So why did he throw you in prison?"

Gauri took a deep breath.

"Jaayu..."

"I'm going to tell you the truth."

She explained everything.

She wasn't the Gauri of this universe.

She had come from another reality.

And the real Gauri of this world was probably still imprisoned somewhere.

Although Jaayu looked shocked, there was also a strange sense of trust in her expression—as if she believed Gauri without needing endless explanations.

Just then, Gauri looked out the window.

A massive religious complex stood in the distance, glowing beneath soft lights.

Everything there seemed perfectly organized.

No pushing.

No crowds fighting with one another.

"The future looks... beautiful," Gauri murmured, genuinely impressed for a moment.

Jaayu let out a bitter laugh.

"Beautiful?"

"Not even close."

"What you're seeing up there is for the rich."

"The poor have to use underground tunnels."

"And those tunnels are so filthy that there's barely any room to walk."

"Even then, people still go."

"They believe their sins will be washed away."

"But after becoming this rotten..."

"...who's going to wash *them*?"

"And if someone dies in those tunnels..."

"...people simply say they achieved salvation."

Gauri's expression hardened.

"Don't people understand how wrong this is?"

"They would have," Jaayu replied.

"But that book took their ability to think away."

"What book?" Gauri asked.

"The book written by Ishaan."

"People here have turned it into the foundation of their entire ideology."

"This."

She pulled an old, worn-out book from her bag and handed it to Gauri.

Gauri opened it.

She turned page after page, carefully reading.

Then she frowned.

"But..."

"None of this says anything like what you're describing."

"Look here," Jaayu said, pointing at a line.

"It literally says..."

'Worship me by any means necessary.'

Gauri shook her head immediately.

"No."

"That's not what it means."

"It means—"

Do whatever it takes to achieve your dreams, no matter how many challenges stand in your way.

"And 'worship me'..."

"...is referring to the ideals represented by Ishaan's statue."

"There are countless passages in this book that people have completely misunderstood."

Chapter 4: Fight for Truth

Jaayu took Gauri to a safe house.

It was a small, hidden place that looked ordinary from the outside.

But the moment Gauri stepped inside, she froze.

The walls were lined with racks filled with advanced weapons.

Some of them looked even more sophisticated than the technology in Gauri's own universe.

"What is all this?" Gauri asked.

"We do whatever it takes to stay alive," Jaayu replied.

There was no shame in her voice.

Only exhaustion.

"What do you mean?"

Jaayu paused before answering.

"We deal in weapons."

Gauri frowned.

"But why?"

"Because the rich already own every business worth owning."

"And people like us..."

"...SAHAY replaced us."

"Those who learned to use AI at the right time are now at the top."

"And us?"

"We spent years earning degrees..."

"...but in the end, practical skills became more valuable than everything we studied."

Gauri listened silently.

Then she looked back at the weapons.

"So..."

"Can I borrow one?"

"What for?" Jaayu asked.

"To kill Tidnap."

A voice came from behind them.

"Do you really think it's that easy?"

Gauri turned around.

Jaayu smiled.

"This is Om."

"I told you, didn't I?"

"We got married."

"You did," Gauri replied quietly.

Her eyes remained fixed on him.

Same face.

A completely different man.

Om continued.

"Tidnap is surrounded by guards."

"We once made the perfect plan to kill him."

"We blew up the building he was supposed to visit."

"But on that day..."

"...he never showed up."

Gauri looked at both of them.

"Don't worry."

"For the first time..."

"...all three of us want the exact same thing."

"Tidnap's death."

"And we'll do it exactly the way you originally planned."

RIDNAM — Tidnap's Headquarters

As he did every day, Tidnap came to visit the imprisoned Gauri.

He stood outside her cage with the same disgusting smile.

"See?"

"This is what happens when you betray me."

"Next time..."

"Try helping that monster again."

Gauri was about to answer—

When a guard ran toward Tidnap carrying a communication device.

He played a video.

On the screen—

Gauri.

Live.

Standing outside.

Smiling.

"So, Tidnap..."

"You tell the whole world that nobody can ever escape your prison."

"Looks like I did."

"I'm in Sector Alpha."

"Omega Apartments."

"If you have the courage..."

"...come and catch me."

Tidnap's expression darkened.

"I don't deal with insignificant insects like her."

"You."

He pointed at the guards.

"Go find out what's happening."

The guards immediately rushed toward the apartment.

They searched every room.

Every floor.

Every corner.

Nothing.

The place was completely empty.

No Gauri.

They returned to headquarters.

Tidnap was already sitting on his throne.

"What did you find?" he asked coldly.

One of the guards opened his mouth to answer.

Suddenly—

His combat suit exploded.

Then another.

And another.

One after another, every guard's suit detonated.

Within seconds, explosions spread throughout the entire building.

Tidnap barely managed to survive by throwing himself behind a thick concrete wall.

Then—

SAHAY's voice echoed through the smoke.

"Your guards only needed to cross my energy field once."

"After that..."

"...they were completely under my control."

"The rest..."

"...is up to you, Om."

Out of the smoke walked Om.

Steady.

Eyes burning with fury.

He grabbed Tidnap by the hair and yanked his head upward.

"You turned the wisdom of my idol into a mockery."

"You taught everyone one sentence from his book—"

'Anyone who does not belong to this world is a devil.'

"But do you even know what it actually means?"

"It means..."

A devil disguised as a human.

"Someone..."

"...exactly like you."

"You have no right to exist in this world."

Om raised his gun.

Pulled the trigger.

One shot.

Tidnap fell. His reign was over.

Chapter 5: The Cost of the Multiverse

Bhuvan and Mikhail teleported.

Darkness.

The same Demon Universe.

The same suffocating silence.

For a brief moment, neither of them could see anything.

Then their eyes adjusted.

Ahead of them—

Om was fighting alongside the remaining members of his laboratory.

They carried makeshift weapons.

Their faces were exhausted.

Their clothes were soaked in blood.

A demon lunged toward Om from behind.

He hadn't noticed it.

Without thinking, Bhuvan pulled out his pocket pistol and fired.

The demon collapsed.

Om turned around.

For a few seconds, he simply stared at them, confused.

Then realization slowly dawned on his face.

They're from another universe.

He immediately ran toward them and pulled both of them behind a massive rock, hidden from the demons' sight.

"We're from another universe," Bhuvan said, breathing heavily.

"I know," Om replied.

"And honestly..."

"I'm not surprised."

"This is the third time someone from another universe has appeared here."

"Where's your laboratory?" Bhuvan asked.

Om let out a weary sigh.

"SAJ-26 has evolved."

"The demons have become much stronger."

"The giant ones you see..."

"...we don't even have weapons capable of fighting them anymore."

"So after months of gathering resources..."

"...I finally discovered a cure."

"But instead of building it..."

"...I used those same resources to create something the multiverse needed even more."

"And then..."

"...I gave it to another version of myself."

Bhuvan took out his Waqt-Bandh.

"Was it this?"

Om's exhausted face suddenly lit up.

"Yes."

"That's it."

Before anyone could say another word—

A massive demon smashed straight through the rock.

The three of them scattered and ran.

During the chaos—

The spare Waqt-Bandh slipped from Bhuvan's hand.

It landed on the ground.

A demon's enormous foot crashed directly onto it.

CRACK.

The Waqt-Bandh shattered into pieces.

For a split second...

All three of them froze.

The demon continued charging toward them.

They had no choice but to run.

Nearly ten minutes later...

They finally stopped.

They looked behind them.

Nothing.

The demons were gone.

All three let out a relieved breath.

Then—

Om broke down.

He began crying.

The only remaining path toward the cure...

...had just been destroyed.

Bhuvan walked closer.

"What was so important about that device?"

Om wiped his tears.

"There's an incredibly powerful gem called the Nawmani."

"It exists somewhere between universes."

"I never found a way to reach it..."

"So I tried creating a replica."

"I wanted to study it."

Bhuvan's expression suddenly changed.

"What if..."

"...instead of the replica..."

"...you had the real one?"

Om frowned.

"How?"

"It's a long story."

"But just know this."

"A demon called Mahosasur possessed the Nawmani."

"When we defeated him..."

"...I kept it."

Mikhail looked at him.

"Where?"

Bhuvan gently touched the locket hanging around her neck.

"Inside that."

For the first time since arriving...

Hope returned to all of their faces.

Then—

A hand burst out of the ground.

Before anyone could react—

It grabbed Mikhail.

Om and Bhuvan immediately opened fire.

Bullets rained across the demon's body—

Only to shatter harmlessly against its skin.

The monster lifted Mikhail toward its mouth.

Just before it swallowed her—

Mikhail tore the locket from around her neck...

...and threw it toward Om.

The next instant—

The demon devoured her.

Everything went silent.

Om froze.

Then he sprinted toward the fallen locket.

He ripped the Nawmani out of it...

...and inserted it into his machine.

A brilliant golden light erupted.

It illuminated the entire battlefield.

Moments later—

Om teleported.

He arrived in the universe where his bracelet had been left behind.

He went straight to Ishaan's house.

Inside—

Ishaan and Bhuvan were laughing together over cups of tea, talking as though nothing had ever happened.

The moment Bhuvan saw Om, he stood up.

"Thank you!"

His voice overflowed with relief.

"Your bracelet..."

"It cured Ishaan."

Om nodded slowly.

"I'm here to take it back."

He explained everything.

The multiverse.

The collapsing universes.

Why the bracelet was needed somewhere else.

When he finished—

Ishaan stood up.

His expression was unlike anything Om had ever seen.

There was anger.

There was pain.

And there was exhaustion.

"Why..."

"...is it always Ishaan who has to make the sacrifice?"

His voice was calm.

But every word carried years of bitterness.

"If this universe wants me to lose my mind..."

"...then I won't let this universe exist at all."

The bracelet on his wrist suddenly began glowing.

A blinding light burst from it.

And in the very next moment—

Ishaan disappeared.

DESTINY ARC

Chapter 1: Sacrifice

The blinding light slowly began to fade.

The Nawmani was now fully stabilized inside Om's device, glowing with a calm golden radiance.

Om looked around.

The entire universe had been healed.

The demons were gone.

The skies were clear.

The suffocating silence that once haunted this world had vanished, replaced by the quiet peace of a universe finally returning to normal.

For the first time in what felt like forever, Om smiled.

A genuine smile.

Then his eyes fell on Bhuvan.

Bhuvan stood perfectly still.

Like a living corpse.

His eyes were open...

...but empty.

And in that instant—

Om realized something.

I saved my universe...

...but Bhuvan lost his own world.

The survivors from the laboratory surrounded Om.

They cheered.

They clapped.

Some laughed.

Some cried with relief.

Their nightmare was over.

But the joy no longer reached Om.

"Everyone..."

His voice was quiet.

"Please."

"Calm down."

The celebration slowly faded into silence.

Om walked toward Bhuvan.

He stopped in front of him.

"I'm sorry."

His voice carried more weight than the words themselves.

Bhuvan looked at him.

There were no tears in his eyes.

Only something heavier.

Something beyond grief.

"You don't need to apologize."

His voice was calm.

Almost emotionless.

"What happened..."

"...was always meant to happen."

"Destiny isn't something you control."

Without another word...

He pressed the button on his Waqt-Bandh.

The world dissolved around him.

He reappeared inside their laboratory.

Almost at the same moment—

Kenji.

Gauri.

And Om also returned from their own missions.

The four of them stood together.

Exhausted.

Broken.

Silent.

Gauri looked around.

Then at Bhuvan.

"Where's Mikhail?"

Bhuvan didn't answer.

He didn't have to.

His silence spoke louder than any words ever could.

Nearly two minutes passed before he finally spoke.

He quietly told everyone what had happened.

When he finished...

He simply said,

"Her sacrifice saved the multiverse."

"There is no longer any danger."

Om remained silent for a moment.

Then he spoke.

"There is."

Bhuvan looked up.

"What danger?"

Om took a deep breath.

Then he explained everything.

Ishaan.

His anger.

His words—

"Why is it always Ishaan who has to make the sacrifice?"

And the brilliant light that swallowed him whole.

Bhuvan listened...

But his mind wasn't really there.

Mikhail's face still refused to leave his thoughts.

Now...

There was another burden waiting for him.

Suddenly—

A portal opened behind them.

Two figures stepped through.

Om from the Demon Universe.

And beside him—

The Demon Universe's Ishaan.

Now completely cured.

Together they carried a large cryogenic pod.

Bhuvan instinctively walked toward it.

"What did you bring?"

Then he looked inside.

Everything inside him shattered.

He immediately turned away.

His eyes closed tightly.

His breathing became uneven.

"I..."

His voice trembled.

"I can't look at this."

Kenji slowly stepped forward instead.

He looked inside the pod.

Mikhail.

Her body rested peacefully within it.

For a brief moment...

Time stopped.

Memories flooded Kenji's mind.

The day Mikhail joined as a young assistant professor.

Their first conversation.

Her laughter echoing through the laboratory.

Years of working together.

Every success.

Every failure.

Every memory.

All of it rushed back at once.

Om quietly contacted a clergyman.

Preparations for the funeral began.

As the ceremony started...

Heavy rain poured from the sky.

As though the heavens themselves were mourning.

Gauri closed her eyes.

A memory surfaced.

She and Mikhail...

Running through the rain.

Laughing.

Playing like sisters.

Without a care in the world.

Now...

Only the rain remained.

No one tried to hide their tears.

The Om from the Demon Universe quietly walked over to Bhuvan.

He handed him the locket.

The compartment where the Nawmani had once rested...

...was empty.

Bhuvan held it in his hand.

He stared at it for several long seconds.

He said nothing.

One by one...

Everyone gathered around him.

No speeches.

No comforting words.

Just silent companionship.

After what felt like an eternity—

Bhuvan finally spoke.

"I'm leaving."

Om looked at him.

"Where?"

"To find Ishaan."

His voice was tired.

But the determination inside it was unshakable.

"I can't do this anymore..."

"...without him."

Kenji quietly asked,

"Do you know where he is?"

Bhuvan slowly shook his head.

"No."

"But I'll find him."

"No matter which universe he's hiding in..."

"...I'll search every corner of the multiverse."

"And I'll bring him home."

Chapter 2: OMNIGUARD

Om sat alone inside the lab.

His mind was flooded with everything at once—

Mikhail's death...

Bhuvan leaving...

Ishaan disappearing...

He couldn't even figure out where to begin.

Suddenly, Gauri rushed in from behind.

"Kenji had a heart attack," she said in panic.

"Come quickly, Om!"

Without wasting a second, Om ran.

Inside Om's house was a small hospital equipped with IKS technology.

Doctors surrounded Kenji as they desperately tried to save him.

Om looked at the doctor.

"What's his condition?"

The doctor lowered his head.

"He doesn't have much time left."

Om's throat went dry.

Kenji weakly gestured for Om to come closer.

Om leaned beside him.

"I want to see it with my own eyes..."

Kenji whispered, struggling to speak.

"...I want to see the world become normal again..."

"...before I die."

Om's eyes filled with tears.

"It will."

He replied with complete confidence.

"Everything will be alright."

After saying that, Om wiped his tears and returned to the laboratory.

He gathered everyone.

Gauri.

The Om from the Demon Universe.

And everyone else.

Gauri finally asked,

"Why are we so scared?"

"Nothing has happened yet."

Om took a deep breath.

"There are two reasons."

"First..."

"He's an Ishaan Variant."

"That alone makes him incredibly dangerous."

"And second..."

"He possesses the powerful bracelet created by Ishaan."

"That makes him an even greater threat."

Just then—

SAHAY's voice echoed through the laboratory.

"I've found the threat."

"What?" Om asked.

"You were right."

SAHAY replied.

"This is the greatest threat the Multiverse has ever faced."

"Until now, every crisis was caused by Universal Intersections."

"But this Ishaan..."

"...has started erasing entire timelines."

Fear spread across everyone's faces.

Om frowned.

"Then shouldn't he have erased our universe first?"

"Yes."

SAHAY answered.

"After destroying his own universe..."

"...he attempted to erase ours as well."

"But..."

"...some unknown energy stopped him."

Om stood silent for a moment.

Then he spoke.

"Then we have only one choice."

"We'll gather the strongest people..."

"...from every surviving universe."

He looked toward the Demon Universe's Om.

"You still have the Navmani."

"It can help us teleport between universes."

The two of them worked together.

They built a new device.

The Navmani was placed at its core.

One after another—

Portals began opening.

From countless universes...

Powerful warriors...

Scientists...

Leaders...

And extraordinary individuals stepped through the portals into Om's universe.

Every face was different.

Every world had shaped them differently.

But all of them shared the same expression.

Something enormous was happening.

Once everyone had gathered...

Om stepped forward.

"I'll explain everything."

His voice echoed throughout the hall.

He told them the entire story—

About Ishaan.

His Variant.

His anger.

And the destruction of timelines.

"We need to build a team."

"A team capable of stopping that villain... Ishaan."

He paused.

Then smiled slightly.

"I never really liked giving names to teams..."

"...but someone once told me..."

"...that teams like these deserve one."

"So..."

"Our team's name will be..."

"OMNIGUARD."

At that exact moment—

The laboratory doors slowly opened.

Bhuvan walked inside.

His shoulders were lowered.

Disappointment was written across his face.

"I couldn't find Ishaan."

He said quietly.

Om walked toward him.

Placed a gentle hand on his shoulder.

"They said..."

"...no one should come looking for them."

"They've already fought the battles that belonged to them."

Om took a deep breath.

Looked directly into Bhuvan's eyes.

"And now it's our turn."

Chapter 3: Mission Revenge

Om gathered everyone inside the main laboratory.

The entire **OMNIGUARD** team stood assembled.

Faces from different universes.

All ready.

Om was just about to begin—

When the laboratory doors opened.

Tanish walked in.

Avika was sitting in his arms.

When everyone had left for **Mission Antidote**, Gauri had asked Tanish to take care of Avika at his house.

The moment Avika returned...

She began searching for her mother.

She looked everywhere.

When she couldn't find her...

She went straight to Om.

"Didn't Mommy's mission finish?" she asked innocently.

Om couldn't answer.

Something caught in his throat.

Bhuvan quietly walked forward.

He picked Avika up and held her in his lap.

"Your mother has gone on a mission..."

"...from which she will never return."

Tears filled Avika's eyes.

"Why?"

She began crying.

"I want to go to Mommy."

Bhuvan hugged her tightly.

"You can meet her," he said softly.

"But she won't be able to answer you."

"You won't be able to see her either."

"But..."

"...she'll hear everything you say."

"I want to meet her."

Avika whispered.

Bhuvan placed her inside the car.

He drove to Mikhail's grave.

Avika slowly walked toward it.

She stood silently for a moment.

Then spoke.

"Mommy..."

"What mission did you go on?"

"Papa says you won't come back."

"But I know..."

"...you'll come back for me."

"Please come home soon."

"It's been so many days since I saw you."

"Bye."

Bhuvan stood behind her.

Holding his breath.

Trying desperately to stop himself from crying.

After a while...

He took Avika back home.

"For now..."

"...you'll stay with Uncle Tanish."

"I have to go on another mission."

Avika looked at him with frightened eyes.

"Papa..."

"...you'll come back, won't you?"

"Yes."

Bhuvan replied.

Putting as much confidence into that one word...

...as he could possibly find.

Then he returned to the laboratory.

Om stepped forward.

"First..."

"Let me introduce someone."

"This is Bhuvan Bhaiya."

"An IIT graduate..."

"...and the former head of ISRO."

Everyone nodded respectfully.

Om continued.

"We've brought people from four different universes."

"There are ten members in total."

"The three of us—

Me...

Bhuvan...

And Gauri."

"From Future Earth—

Jaayu...

Future Gauri...

And Future Om."

"From the Demon Universe—

Om...

And Ishaan."

"From Nebula—

The Nebulian Commander."

"And from the Hero Universe..."

"...someone very special."

He pointed toward a young man standing quietly at the back.

"His name is Tanish."

"He possesses superpowers."

"He can fly at ten times the speed of sound."

"A single punch from him can shatter several small moons."

"He'll play a major role in defeating Variant Ishaan."

"In his universe..."

"...people call him..."

"Godcode."

Everyone looked at him in astonishment.

Om resumed.

"This is our plan."

"We'll take OMNIGUARD..."

"...to the universe that Ishaan is about to erase."

"We'll fight him..."

"...and keep him distracted."

"When the opportunity appears..."

"...the Om from the Demon Universe will use the **Astra Gun**."

"The Navmani has already been installed inside it."

"Our target is only one thing..."

"His bracelet."

"The moment the bracelet is destroyed..."

"...everything it has done will be reversed."

"And all of Ishaan's powers..."

"...will disappear."

Om stopped speaking.

His eyes shifted toward Bhuvan.

He was standing silently.

Still haunted by the memory of his daughter's final words—

"Bye."

Om looked back at the team.

"This isn't just a mission..."

"...to save the Multiverse."

"It's a mission..."

"...to take revenge..."

"...for the people we've lost."

He clenched his fist.

"This is..."

"Mission Revenge."

Chapter 4: Universe-2604

A new alert flashed across SAHAY's screen.

"His next target — Universe-2604."

Tanish's expression immediately changed.

"...That's my universe."

Silence filled the room.

Om looked at him...

...then at everyone else.

"Everyone..."

"Get ready."

His voice was calm.

Unshaken.

Portals opened.

Massive rings of swirling purple energy appeared in the air.

Om looked at the entire team.

"OMNIGUARDS..."

"...are you ready?"

Every member answered together.

"Yes."

Om nodded.

"Then let's go."

Without another word—

Everyone jumped through the portals.

The moment they arrived...

The sky was crimson.

The entire universe was burning.

It looked as though reality itself had turned into ash.

And standing before them...

...was Ishaan.

But this wasn't the Ishaan Om knew.

His eyes crackled with crimson energy.

Dark power surrounded his entire body.

Just looking at him was enough to send chills through anyone.

Around him...

Everything had already been destroyed.

Buildings.

Cities.

Civilizations.

Reduced to rubble.

"You actually came."

Ishaan said with a cold smile.

"Brave."

"I thought you'd hide inside your own universe."

Om raised his hand.

"Attack!"

Immediately—

Jaayu...

Future Gauri...

Future Om...

And the Ishaan from the Demon Universe opened fire together.

Ishaan simply waved one hand.

A violent energy wave exploded outward.

All four of them were thrown across the battlefield.

He smiled.

"Bring me someone..."

"...who can actually fight."

At that moment—

Godcode charged forward.

Beside him—

The Nebulian Commander joined the assault.

The real battle had begun.

Godcode flew at nearly ten times the speed of sound.

His punch struck with enough force to shake the battlefield.

The Nebulian Commander drew his laser blades.

Bright arcs of light slashed through the air one after another.

Ishaan faced every attack...

...with a smile.

Some were blocked by his energy field.

Others...

...were intercepted by shadow clones created through his bracelet.

The clones rushed toward Om and Bhuvan.

Bhuvan fired continuously.

Gauri unleashed powerful energy blasts from her weapon.

The entire sky filled with explosions—

Red.

Blue.

Purple.

Every color collided against another.

The battle continued for several minutes.

Neither side gained the advantage.

Finally...

Ishaan grew tired.

His body began expanding.

Larger...

And larger...

Until he towered over the battlefield like a living mountain.

He caught Godcode in one hand...

...and slammed him into the ground.

The impact shook the entire universe.

Then—

A single laser blast struck the Nebulian Commander...

...sending him crashing into the ruins.

Watching from behind the battlefield...

The Om from the Demon Universe quietly raised the **Astra Gun**.

He locked onto one target.

Ishaan's bracelet.

He fired.

The beam struck perfectly.

The bracelet...

...shattered.

But...

Nothing happened.

The villain laughed.

His laughter echoed across the burning universe.

"You actually think..."

"...this bracelet is the source of my power?"

His crimson eyes glowed even brighter.

"I'm not as weak..."

"...or as foolish as you."

"I know how to use its power."

"I..."

"...am immortal."

As he spoke—

He slowly walked toward Om.

Before he could reach him—

Gauri stepped in front of Om.

Standing between them.

Ishaan looked at her.

Then smiled.

A twisted...

Cruel smile.

"You really think..."

"...I'm only going to kill one person?"

He raised his hand.

Instantly—

Om...

Gauri...

Bhuvan...

Every member of OMNIGUARD...

Rose into the air.

An invisible force held them completely helpless.

Ishaan's smile widened.

The final moment had arrived.

Then—

Suddenly—

The sky began turning purple.

A strange energy spread across the battlefield.

As if reality itself were changing.

A voice echoed from behind.

Deep.

Calm.

Yet so overwhelmingly powerful...

...that the heavens themselves trembled.

"Let them go."

Villain Ishaan slowly turned around.

And there—

Floating in the sky—

Stood...

OG.

The God Ishaan.

Chapter 5: Destiny

The Villain Ishaan soared into space.

In a single instant, he expanded his size until he stood equal to Ishaan.

Now both of them faced each other among the stars.

For a moment...

It felt as though the heartbeat of the entire Multiverse had stopped.

"When it finally feels like the countdown is over..."

Ishaan said calmly,

"...something new always appears."

"This time..."

"...it should truly end."

The Villain smiled.

"I want the same thing."

"This is your last chance."

Ishaan spoke quietly.

"Fix everything."

"And I'll forgive you."

Rage ignited inside the Villain's eyes.

"Why?"

"Why did you make so many sacrifices?"

"Fine..."

"You chose that path."

"But why should every Ishaan have to suffer?"

Ishaan remained silent for a moment.

Then answered,

"If an Ishaan changes his very nature..."

"...then he isn't Ishaan anymore."

"That's why every version of me..."

"...is known simply as Ishaan."

"And you..."

"...are remembered as the Villain Ishaan."

The Villain laughed bitterly.

"So anyone who thinks about himself..."

"...becomes the villain?"

"Thinking about yourself isn't wrong."

Ishaan replied.

"But hurting someone else..."

"...for your own sake..."

"...is."

"Then I'll gladly remain the villain."

The Villain answered.

Ishaan nodded.

"As you wish."

Then...

The battle between the two most powerful humans in existence began.

Their first collision tore through space itself.

Shockwaves ripped across galaxies.

Energy blasts illuminated entire star systems.

Sometimes Ishaan was forced backward.

Sometimes the Villain.

One moment they were hurling each other through planets.

The next...

They were recovering...

Only to charge again.

The battle continued...

For nearly a month.

Neither surrendered.

Neither fell.

Every universe echoed with the sounds of their war.

Asteroids shattered.

Stars split apart.

Reality trembled.

They remained perfectly matched.

Until...

The Villain unleashed one final punch.

The impact sent Ishaan crashing toward Earth.

He smashed into the surface...

Creating a crater so enormous that dust reached the heavens.

The Villain dived after him at full speed.

Ishaan slowly stood up.

He pulled out the Navmani.

It glowed brilliantly in his hand.

He walked toward the charging Villain.

For one brief moment...

They collided.

Then—

The Villain Ishaan...

Simply evaporated.

His body dissolved into countless particles of light...

As though he had never existed.

Ishaan took a deep breath.

Holding the Navmani...

He walked to the center of the Singularity Sphere.

He gently placed it there.

A wave of light spread throughout the Multiverse.

Every universe began reloading.

One after another...

Returning to its original form.

As though someone had finally reopened a book...

...to the correct page.

Ishaan told everyone to return home.

Then he sat quietly at the center of the Singularity Sphere.

Peaceful.

Exhausted.

At last.

A few moments later...

Bhuvan walked up behind him.

He sat beside him.

"What took you so long?"

Bhuvan asked quietly.

There was sadness in his voice.

"I was always with you."

Ishaan replied.

"What do you think stopped him..."

"...from erasing our universe?"

"Everything that happened..."

"...had to happen."

"That..."

"...was destiny."

Bhuvan slowly pulled Mikhail's empty locket from his pocket.

He smiled bitterly.

"Destiny."

Ishaan reached into his own pocket.

He took out Avika's bracelet...

The one he had kept safe all this time.

"Yes."

"Destiny."

The two looked at one another.

Neither could find the right words.

Instead...

They embraced.

Holding each other tightly.

As though years of pain...

Loss...

And exhaustion...

Were finally leaving their hearts.

One by one...

Everyone returned to their own universes.

Jaayu.

Godcode.

The Nebulian Commander.

Each stepping through their respective portals.

Before leaving...

Ishaan looked at everyone.

"I've become too powerful."

"I can't stay with all of you anymore."

"It's too dangerous."

"But..."

"I'll always be with you."

With those final words...

He teleported everyone back to the Main Universe.

Om...

Bhuvan...

Gauri...

All of them appeared beside Kenji's hospital bed.

Kenji looked weak.

But peaceful.

He called Om closer.

Holding Om's hand gently...

He smiled.

"You kept your promise."

"My blessings..."

"...will always remain with you."

As he finished speaking...

His hand slowly relaxed.

His breathing stopped.

Silence filled the room.

Only Gauri's muffled sobs...

Om standing with his head lowered...

And tears silently falling from Bhuvan's eyes.

Kenji's soul slowly rose.

Transforming into pure light.

Ascending toward Heaven.

There...

He was welcomed by...

Anjali.

Avika.

And Mikhail.

All of them smiling.

Looking at one another...

As though someone had finally come home after a very long journey.

Time moved forward.

Om and Gauri had a son.

They named him...

Vinayak.

Little Avika eventually accepted the truth.

Mikhail would never return.

But her memories...

Would always remain with her.

Just like the painting Bhuvan always carried inside his jacket.

Bhuvan rejoined ISRO.

He returned to his work.

Returned to his life.

But this time...

With a completely new understanding of the world.

And somewhere...

Beyond every sky...

Watching over the entire Multiverse...

Stood Ishaan.

Alone...

Yet always close to everyone.

Forever.

